Essentials of Innovation & Entrepreneurship (EIE) - II

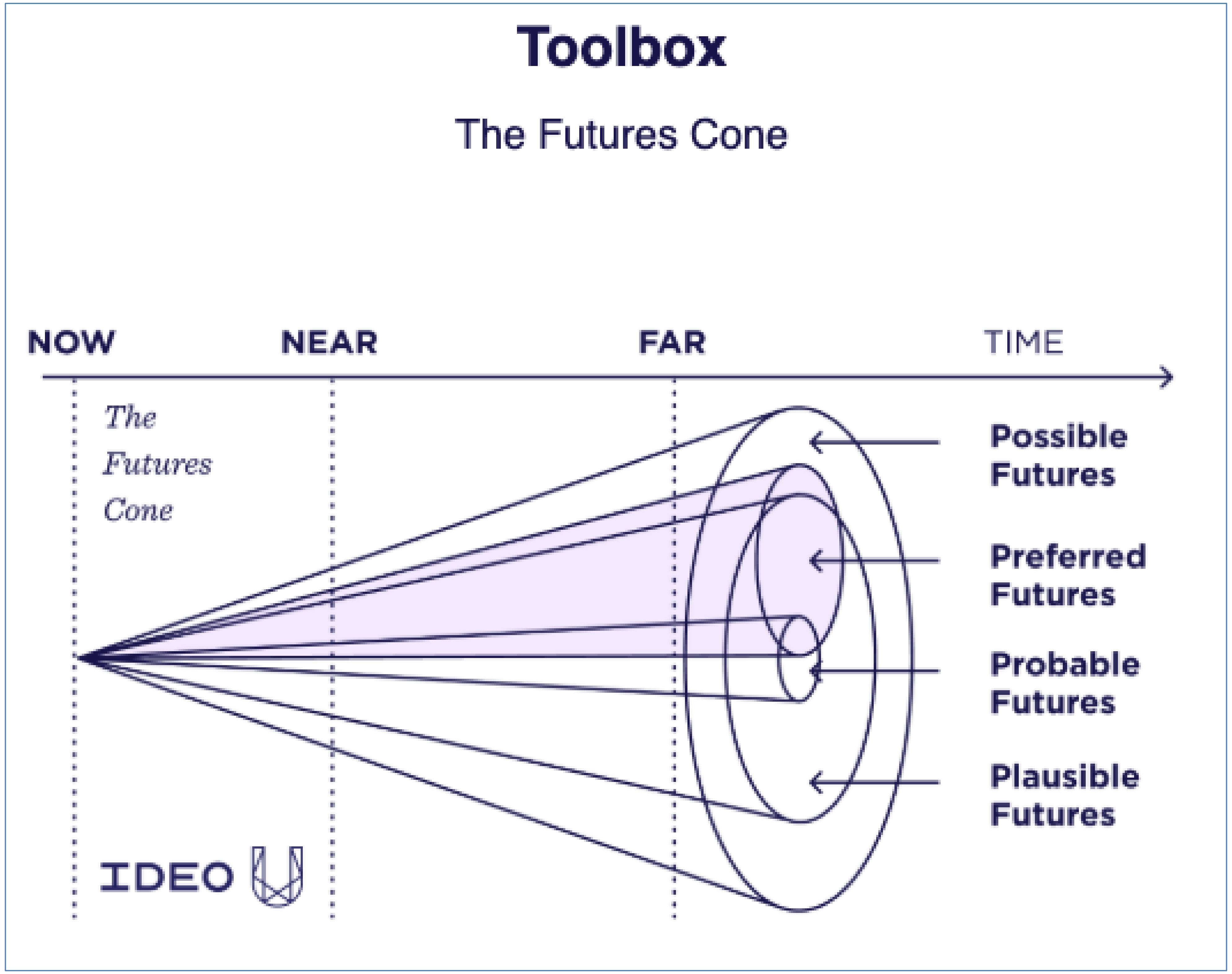
Module (M9): Startup Finance 201

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP
cie

PES UNIVERSITY
CELEBRATING 50 YEARS

EIE2-Icebreaker:
I&E Roundup this Week (Mar 25)

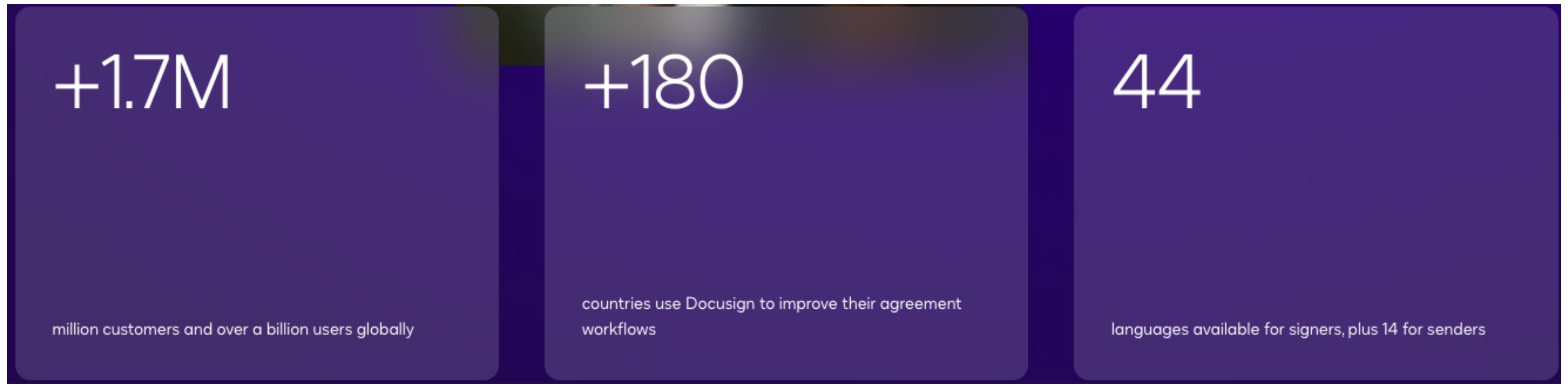
How to Think Like a Futurist?



"The Futures Cone maps a range of possible futures, from probable to plausible to possible.
Instead of betting on one outcome, use it to widen your view and test decisions against multiple scenarios."

Source: Link; IDEO

Break Rules and Still be Successful?



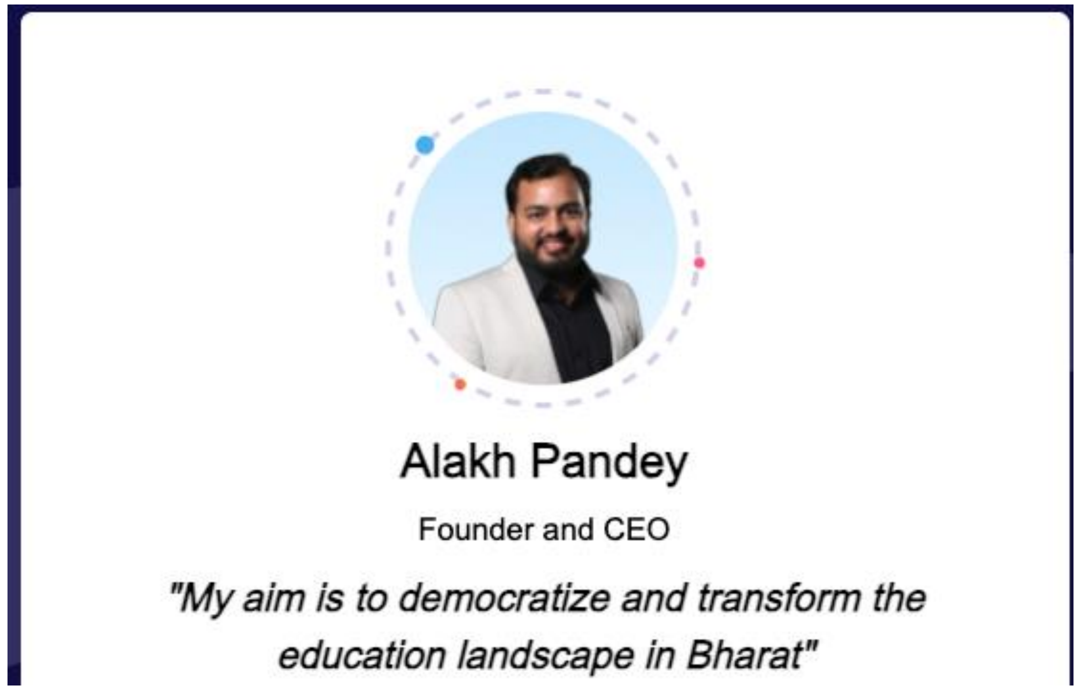
Conventional Startup Principle	DocuSign Reality
New tech → new problem	Old problem → better execution
Fast MVP → iterate quickly	Slow adoption due to regulation/ecosystem
Consumer-first growth	Enterprise-first, trust-driven growth
Speed is everything	Persistence and timing mattered more
Product-market fit is key	Market + regulatory readiness equally critical
Young founders, fresh ideas	Experienced founder, pattern recognition

Providing electronic signatures to offering **Intelligent Agreement Management (IAM)**, a comprehensive platform that handles the entire agreement process.

Source: Link; Docusign

Is Content/Community more powerful than Capital?

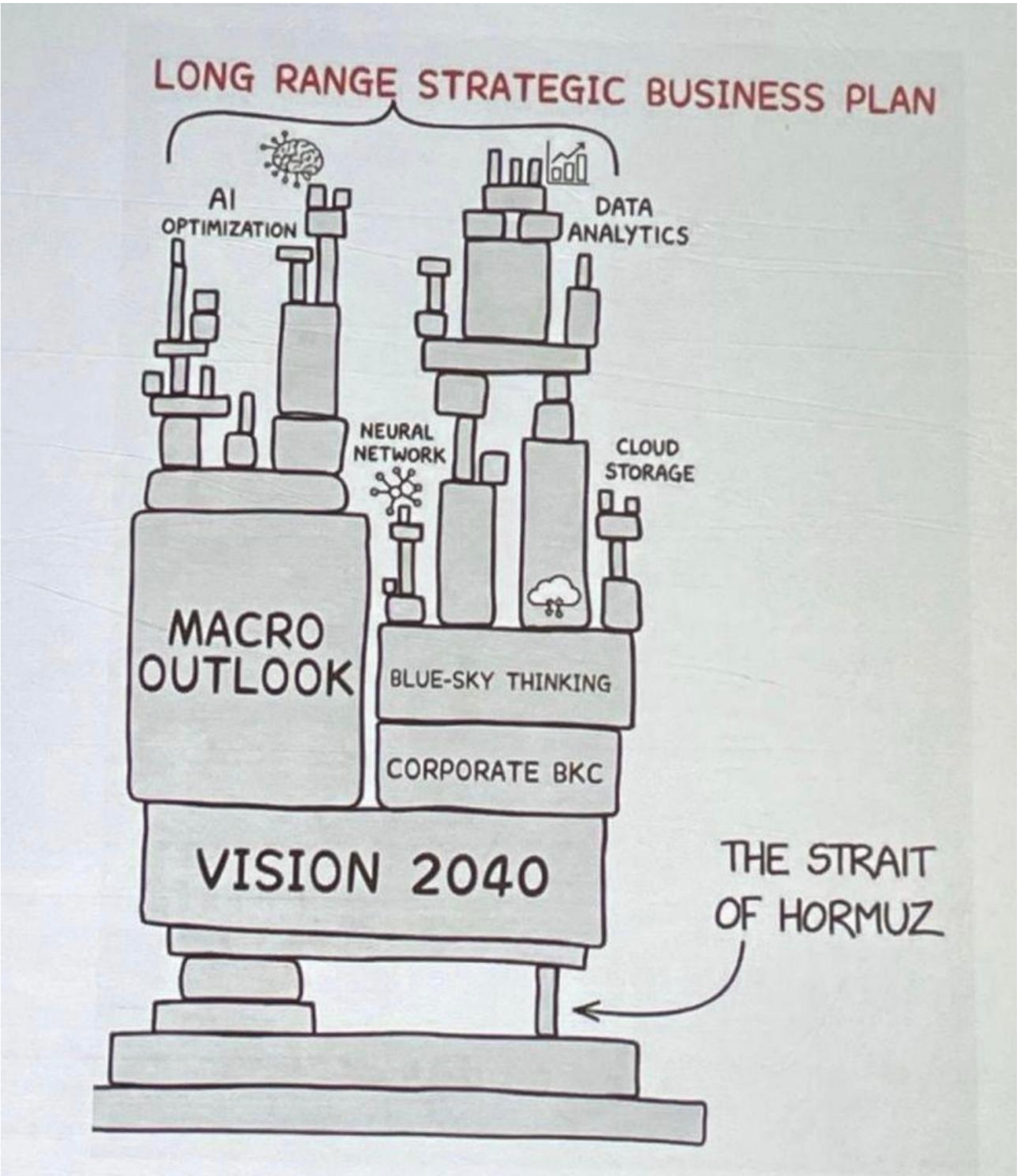
Typical Startup Rule	PhysicsWallah Approach
Raise VC funding early and scale fast	Built audience first, funding later
Premium pricing signals quality	Kept courses highly affordable
Founder as CEO/operator	Founder remained a teacher
Blitzscaling is essential	Scaled gradually and deliberately
Product → then distribution	Distribution (YouTube) → then product
Tech/platform is the core	Content and teaching quality came first



"Reaching 98% of India`s pin codes. PW has more than 10 million paid students on the PW App.
PW also provides quality education to more than 36 million students through its 80 YouTube channels in 8 vernacular languages"

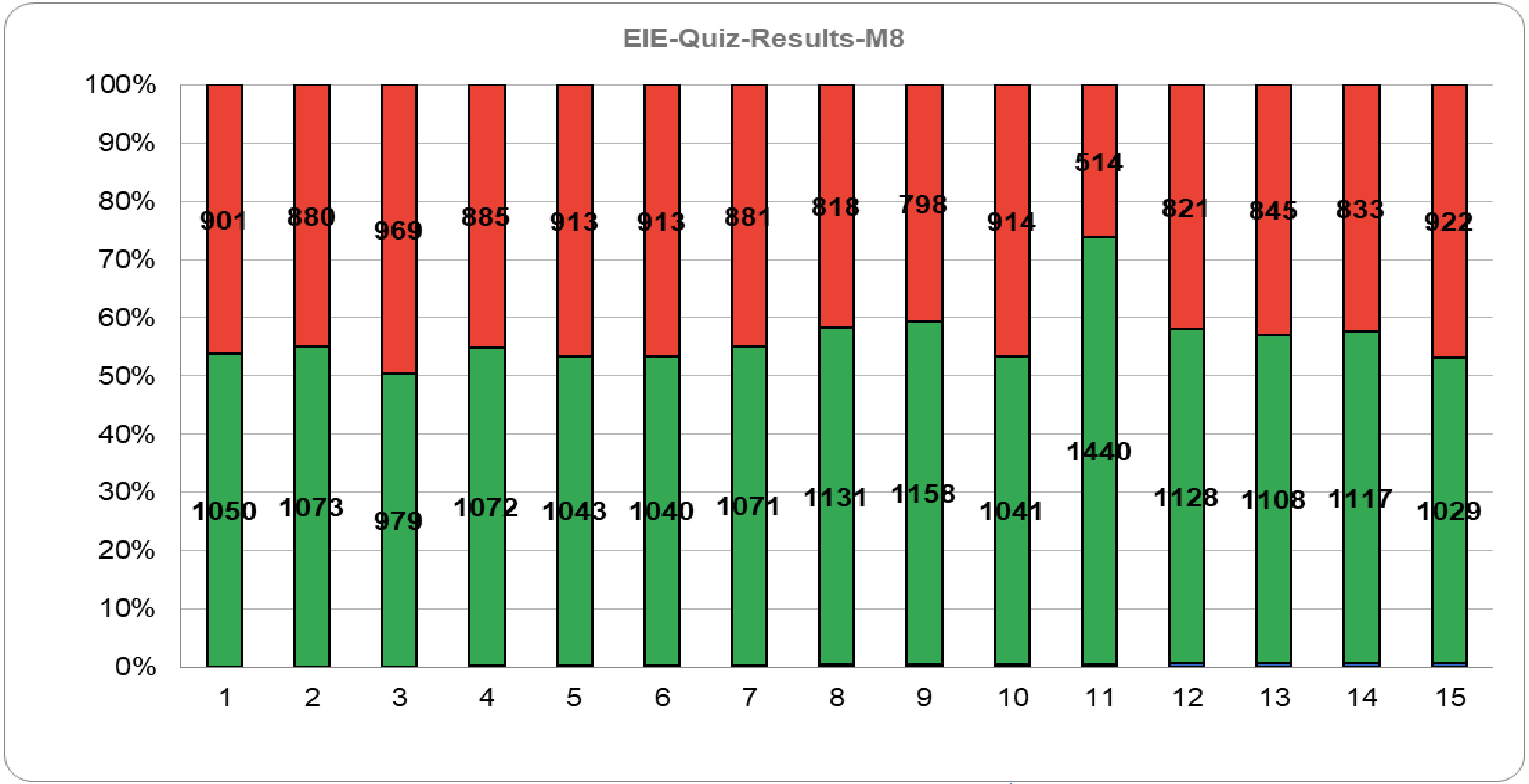
Source: Link; Physics Wallah

Business Plans...



Elon Musk: Twitter(X)

EIE M8 Session Quiz - Discussion / Recap



EIE M8 Session Quiz - Discussion / Recap

PES UNIVERSITY

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

3. In financial accounting for startups and businesses, the fundamental accounting equation helps founders understand how company resources are structured. Which equation correctly represents this relationship?

a) Assets + Liability = Equity
b) Assets – Liability = Owner's Equity - 979 students got it right!
c) Assets × Liability = Profit
d) Assets – Equity = Revenue

10. Before an investor provides new funding, the startup's value is estimated based on its current state, traction, and potential. What is this value called?

a) Pre-money valuation - 1041 students got it right!
b) Post-investment value
c) Revenue forecast
d) Market capitalization

15. A startup raises $500,000 from investors and spends approximately $50,000 every month on operations. Assuming expenses remain constant, how long can the startup operate before running out of cash?

a) 5 months
b) 8 months
c) 0 months - 1029 students got it right!
d) 12 months

M8 Recap – Placeholder for Quiz

Menti code: **8600 8512**

M8 – Pitching and Prototyping - Recap

Startup Pitch

- Why – Problem matters
- What – What you're building
- How – How it works & makes money
- Include: Hook, Problem, Solution, Traction, Market, Revenue Model, Team, Call-To-Action (CTA)
- Good pitch: Audience focus, Data, Clear narrative, Presence
- Avoid: Jargon, text-heavy slides, reading slides, no rehearsal

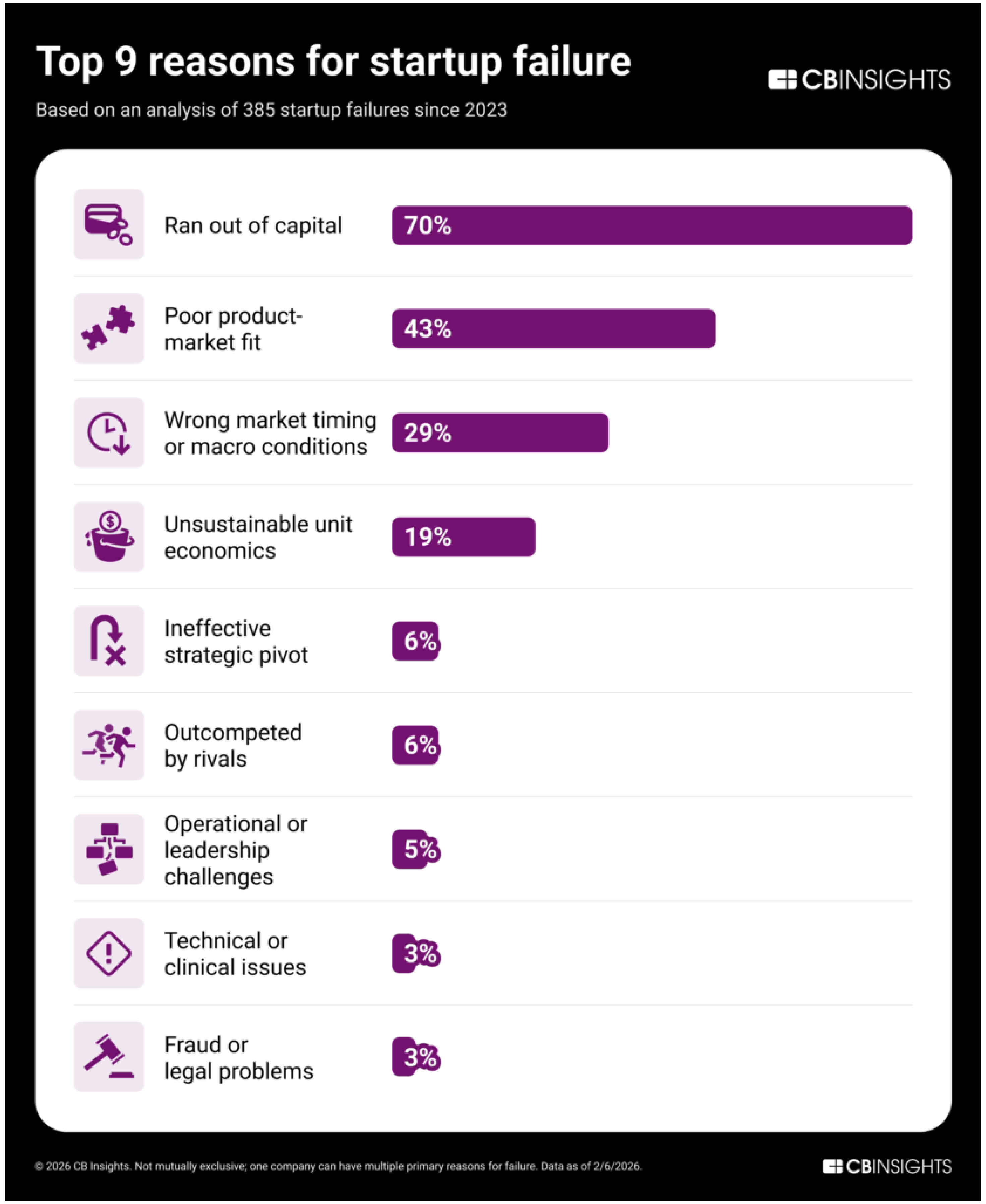
Prototyping

- ✓ Test assumptions early
- ✓ Get real user feedback
- ✓ Reduce cost & risk
- ✓ Enable fast iteration
- ✓ Fidelity depends on what you're testing (low → high)
- ✓ Loop: Build → Test → Adjust → Repeat
- ✓ MVP: Smallest version that validates core assumption

Essentials of Innovation & Entrepreneurship (EIE) II:

Module (M9): Startup Finance 201

Top reasons for startups to fail



CB Insights – 5th March 2026 Report states that 70% Startups Fail because they Ran out of Capital (aka ca)sh

https://www.cbinsights.com/research/report/startup-failure-reasons-top/

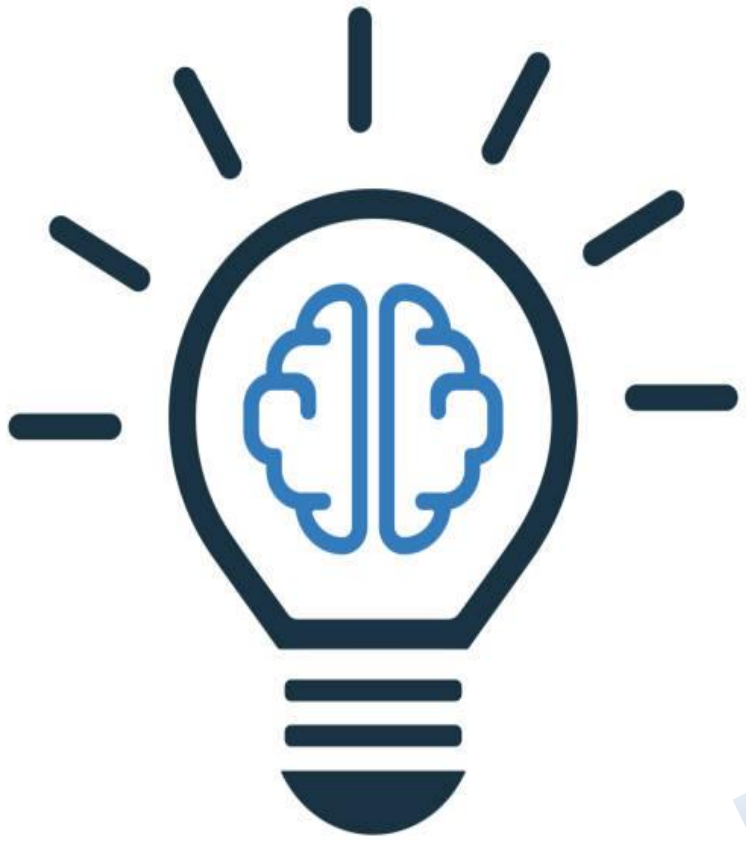
CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

cie

Startup Finance - Looking Beyond Numbers

PES UNIVERSITY

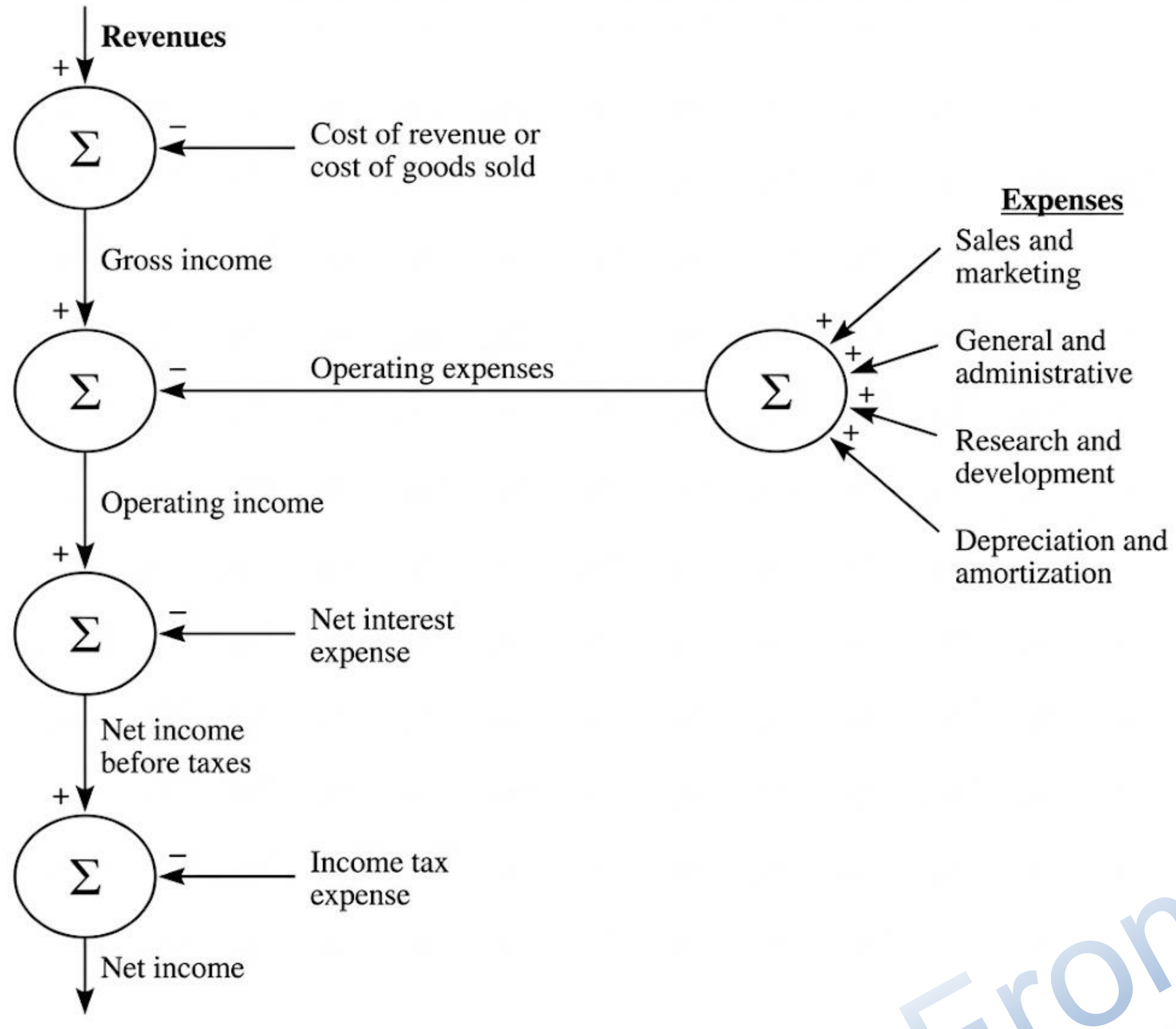
Critical knowledge that will help you go beyond numbers:



- Decide with data
- Chart your startup’s Growth
- Manage Profitably

*** Track Performance, Forecast future needs and avoid cash shortages**

Key Terms



Revenues
+
Σ
−
Cost of revenue or
cost of goods sold
Gross income
+
Σ
−
Operating expenses
Σ
Expenses
Sales and
marketing
General and
administrative
Research and
development
Depreciation and
amortization
+
+
+
+
Operating income
+
Σ
−
Net interest
expense
Net income
before taxes
+
Σ
−
Income tax
expense
Net income

Fundamental Accounting Equation

ASSETS – LIABILITY = OWNER'S EQUITY

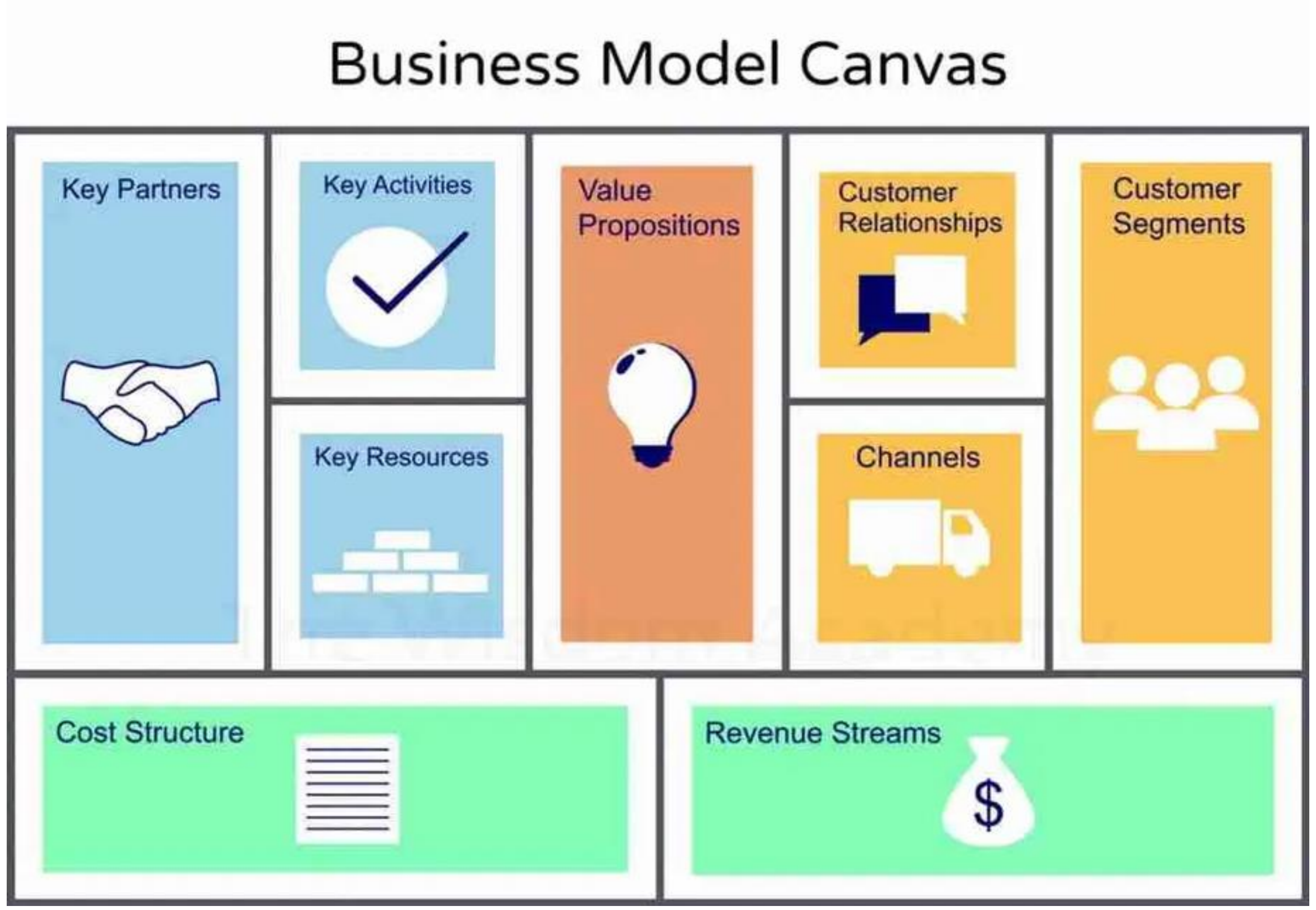
Resources a company can put to work for the business	Debts to suppliers, creditors	What you 'own'
Current Assets: cash, financial instruments (stocks, bonds, etc), inventories of raw materials, finished goods, money owed by customers for goods/service purchased (accounts receivables) Fixed Assets: Property, Plant, Equipment	Includes funds owed to suppliers (accounts payable), loans, income taxes	(Capital contributed by owners + Company's total retained Earnings)

Key Questions

- How do you go from "Business Model Canvas" (aka BMC) to a "Business/Financial Model"?
- Can your startup be profitable and still go under (or fail)?
- What happens to my stake in a startup when I raise capital through equity?

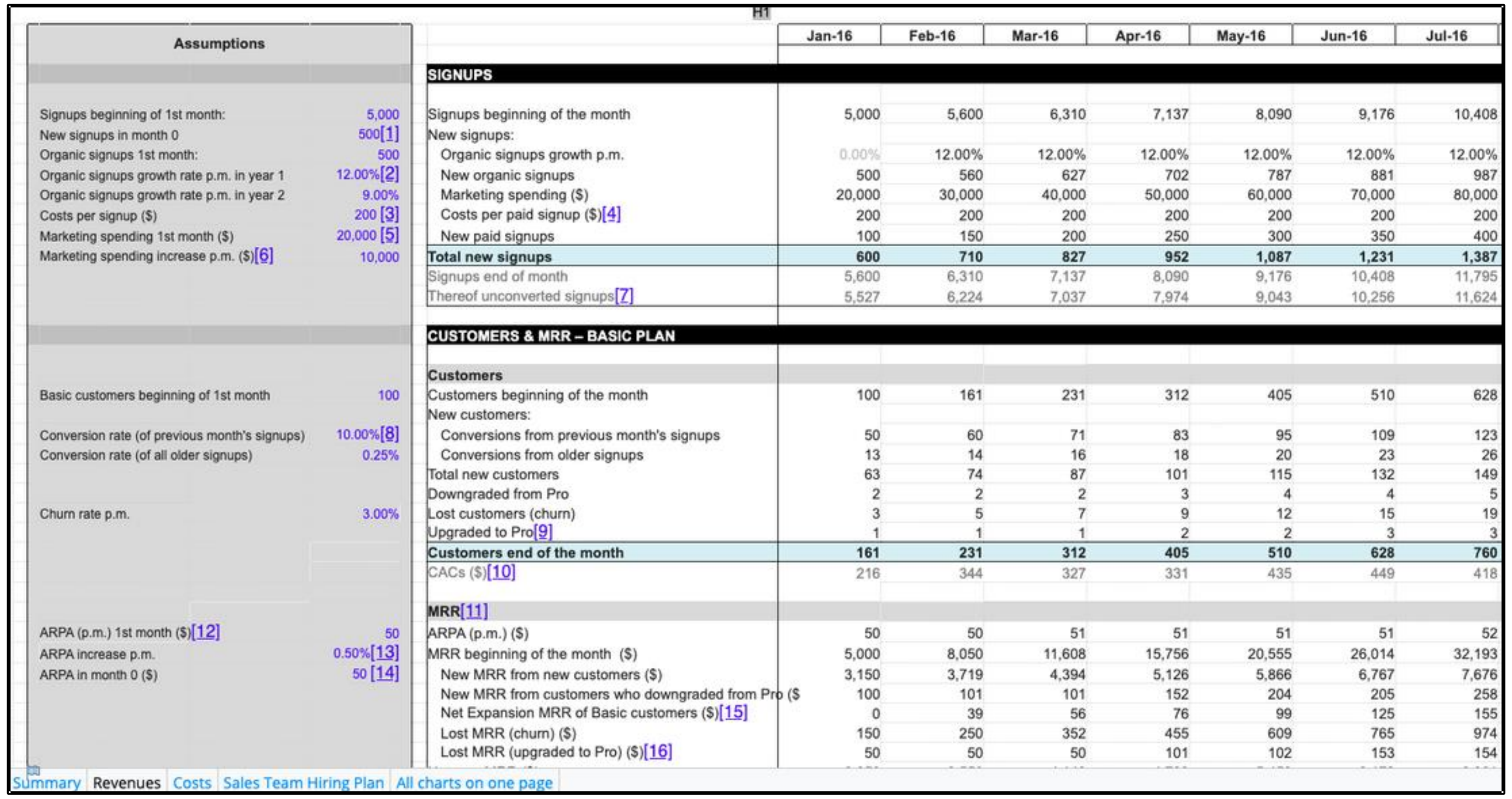
The Next Step

Business Model Canvas



- Capture and validate key assumptions
- Prototype key elements of the Business Model
- Flexible & lightweight (compared to business plan)

Business/Financial Model



Assumptions	
Signups beginning of 1st month:	5,000
New signups in month 0	500[1]
Organic signups 1st month:	500
Organic signups growth rate p.m. in year 1	12.00%[2]
Organic signups growth rate p.m. in year 2	9.00%
Costs per signup ($)	200 [3]
Marketing spending 1st month ($)	20,000 [5]
Marketing spending increase p.m. ($)[6]	10,000
Basic customers beginning of 1st month	100
Conversion rate (of previous month's signups)	10.00%[8]
Conversion rate (of all older signups)	0.25%
Churn rate p.m.	3.00%
ARPA (p.m.) 1st month ($)[12]	50
ARPA increase p.m.	0.50%[13]
ARPA in month 0 ($)	50 [14]

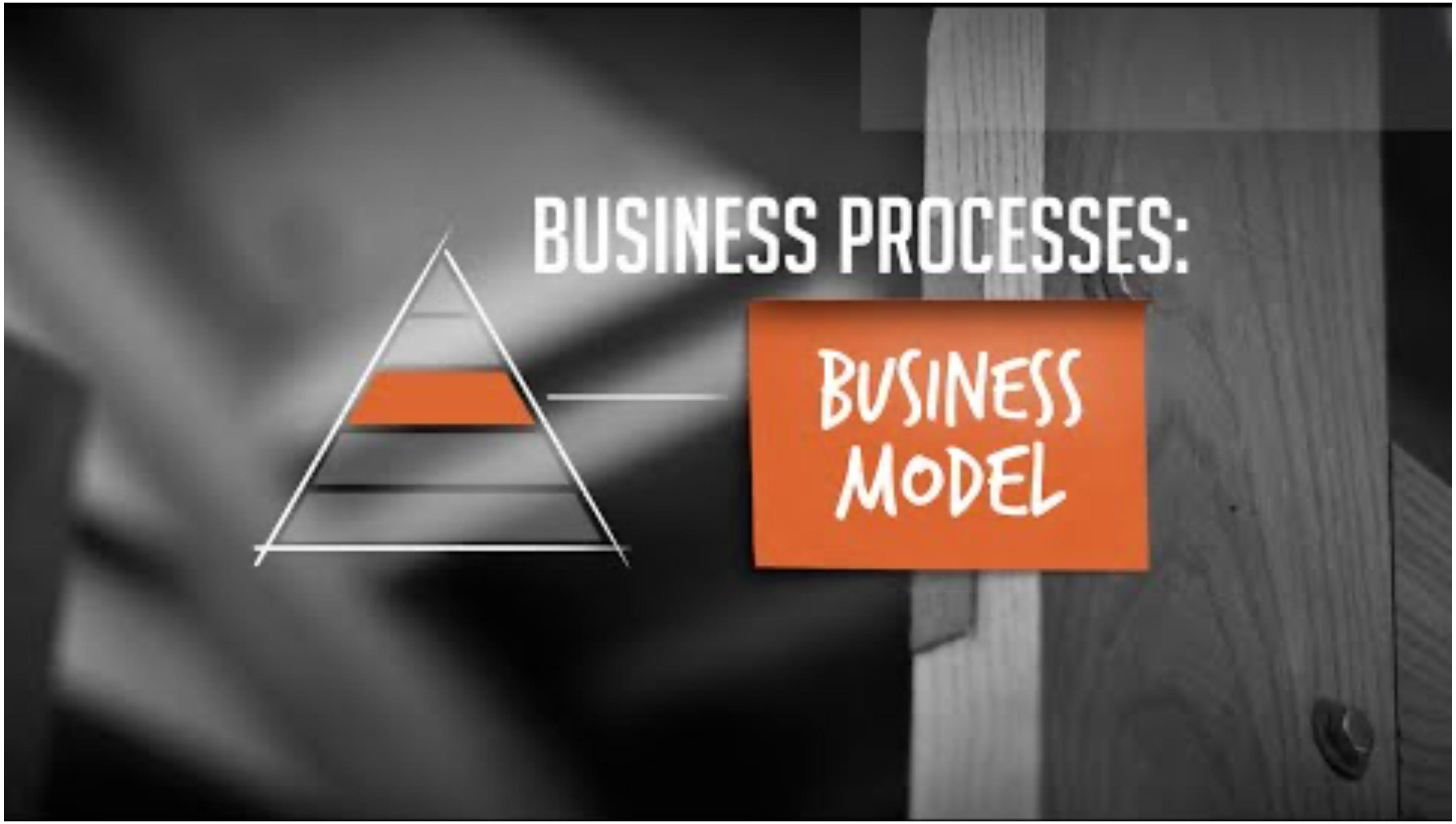
	Jan-16	Feb-16	Mar-16	Apr-16	May-16	Jun-16	Jul-16
SIGNUPS							
Signups beginning of the month	5,000	5,600	6,310	7,137	8,090	9,176	10,408
New signups:							
Organic signups growth p.m.	0.00%	12.00%	12.00%	12.00%	12.00%	12.00%	12.00%
New organic signups	500	560	627	702	787	881	987
Marketing spending ($)	20,000	30,000	40,000	50,000	60,000	70,000	80,000
Costs per paid signup ($)[4]	200	200	200	200	200	200	200
New paid signups	100	150	200	250	300	350	400
Total new signups	**600**	**710**	**827**	**952**	**1,087**	**1,231**	**1,387**
Signups end of month	5,600	6,310	7,137	8,090	9,176	10,408	11,795
Thereof unconverted signups[7]	5,527	6,224	7,037	7,974	9,043	10,256	11,624
CUSTOMERS & MRR – BASIC PLAN							
Customers							
Customers beginning of the month	100	161	231	312	405	510	628
New customers:							
Conversions from previous month's signups	50	60	71	83	95	109	123
Conversions from older signups	13	14	16	18	20	23	26
Total new customers	63	74	87	101	115	132	149
Downgraded from Pro	2	2	2	3	4	4	5
Lost customers (churn)	3	5	7	9	12	15	19
Upgraded to Pro[9]	1	1	1	2	2	3	3
Customers end of the month	**161**	**231**	**312**	**405**	**510**	**628**	**760**
CACs ($)[10]	216	344	327	331	435	449	418
MRR[11]							
ARPA (p.m.) ($)	50	50	51	51	51	51	52
MRR beginning of the month ($)	5,000	8,050	11,608	15,756	20,555	26,014	32,193
New MRR from new customers ($)	3,150	3,719	4,394	5,126	5,866	6,767	7,676
New MRR from customers who downgraded from Pro ($	100	101	101	152	204	205	258
Net Expansion MRR of Basic customers ($)[15]	0	39	56	76	99	125	155
Lost MRR (churn) ($)	150	250	352	455	609	765	974
Lost MRR (upgraded to Pro) ($)[16]	50	50	50	101	102	153	154

Summary | Revenues | Costs | Sales Team Hiring Plan | All charts on one page

- Revenue and Cost modeling
- Generate/analyze key financial metrics / KPIs
- Strategic Planning, Financial health, Decision making

The Art of Startup Finance: Your Business Model Formula (link)

(Kauffman Foundation, 5:25 m)



https://youtu.be/V5QNp57xaeI?feature=shared

Can your startup be **Profitable** and still **Fail**?

- Both cash flow and profit are critical. But they are *NOT* the same thing!

- Understanding the difference can determine whether a startup survives or fails

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RnnO-5cqpF4&t=145s

Profit v/s Cash Flow

Profit

("Bottom Line")

- Profit (or net income) is what's left after subtracting all expenses from revenue.
- It's what the company earns on paper and
- is reported in the income statement.

Cash Flow

("Oxygen" or "lifeblood" of a business)

- Cash flow is the actual movement of money in and out of the business.
- It's tracked in the cash flow statement and determines whether a company can pay its bills.

Profitable and Cash Flow - Example

Example:

If a business sells $100,000 worth of products but allows customers to pay in 90 days,

it may show a profit on paper, but it does not yet have the cash to pay expenses.

Example:

A startup raises $500,000 from investors but spends $50,000 a month.

Even if it’s not profitable yet, it has cash flow to survive for 10 months.

The Art of Startup Finance: Cash Flow (link)

(Kauffman Foundation, 4:21 m)

Raising Funds Through Equity-Valuation: An Introduction

- What is Valuation?
- Pre-Money vs. Post-Money Valuation
- Examples

Startup Valuation: Why This Matters?

Determining Investor Ownership

- Investors get equity based on post-money valuation
- If the valuation is not optimal, founders may give away more equity than they intended

Dilution Awareness

- Founders must understand how each investment affects their percentage ownership and future fundraising rounds

Negotiating Power

- If founders understand Pre and Post-money valuation, they can negotiate better and retain more control of their company

Pre-Money vs. Post-Money Value

- When a startup raises money, investors & founders need to agree on the startup's valuation.
- Valuation determines how much ownership (equity) the investor will receive in exchange for their investment.

Two key terms in this process are:

a. **Pre-Money Valuation**:

   The value of the startup before receiving a new investment

b. **Post-Money Valuation**:

   The value of the startup after receiving a new investment

POST-MONEY VALUATION = PRE-MONEY VALUATION + INVESTMENT AMOUNT

Pre-Money vs. Post-Money Value

Imagine a startup, Stufone, valued at $4 million pre-money.
An investor decides to invest $1 million.

- Pre-Money Valuation: **$4 million**
- Investment Amount: **$1 million**
- Post-Money Valuation: **$5 million ($4M + $1M)**
- Investor Ownership: **20% of the startup ($1M ÷ $5M)**
- If the founders initially owned **100%**, they now own **80%** (100% – 20%) after this round

Pre-Money vs. Post-Money Value

In 2009, Airbnb struggled to raise money and accepted a $600,000 investment at a $2.4 million pre-money valuation from Sequoia Capital. What % of the stake did Sequoia Capital get?

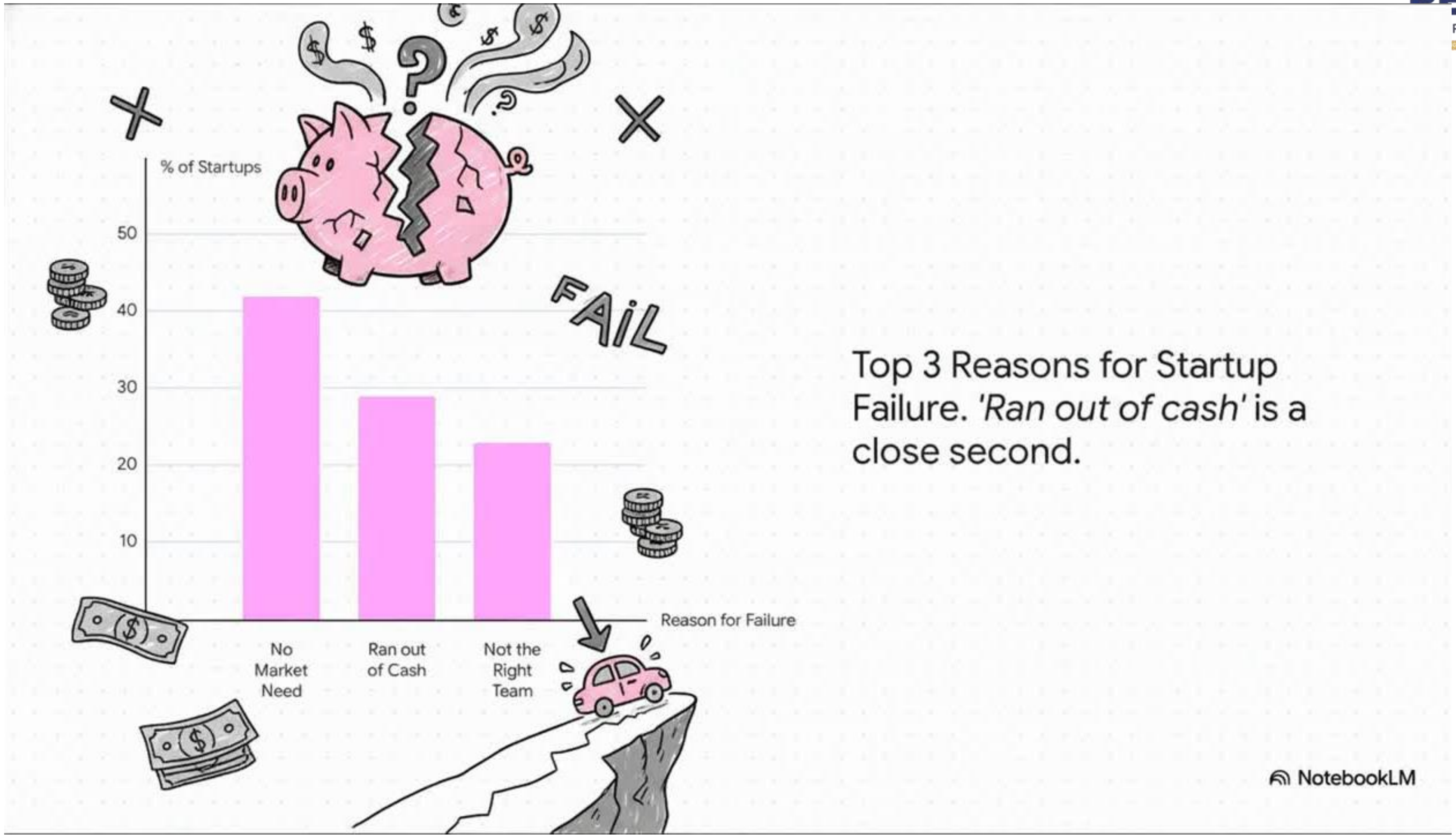
- Pre-Money Valuation: **$2.4 million**
- Investment Amount: **$0.6 million ($600,000)**
- Post-Money Valuation: **$3 million ($2.4M + $0.6M)**
- Investor Ownership: **20%** of startup (founder's share went down by the same %)

Pre-Money vs. Post-Money Value

Key Takeaways

- Always clarify whether a valuation is *pre* or *post*-money. A misunderstanding can lead to unexpected dilution.
- Founders prefer higher pre-money valuation as it means they give away less equity
- Investors prefer lower pre-money valuations since they get a bigger ownership stake for the same amount of money.

Startup Finance Video



Dilution

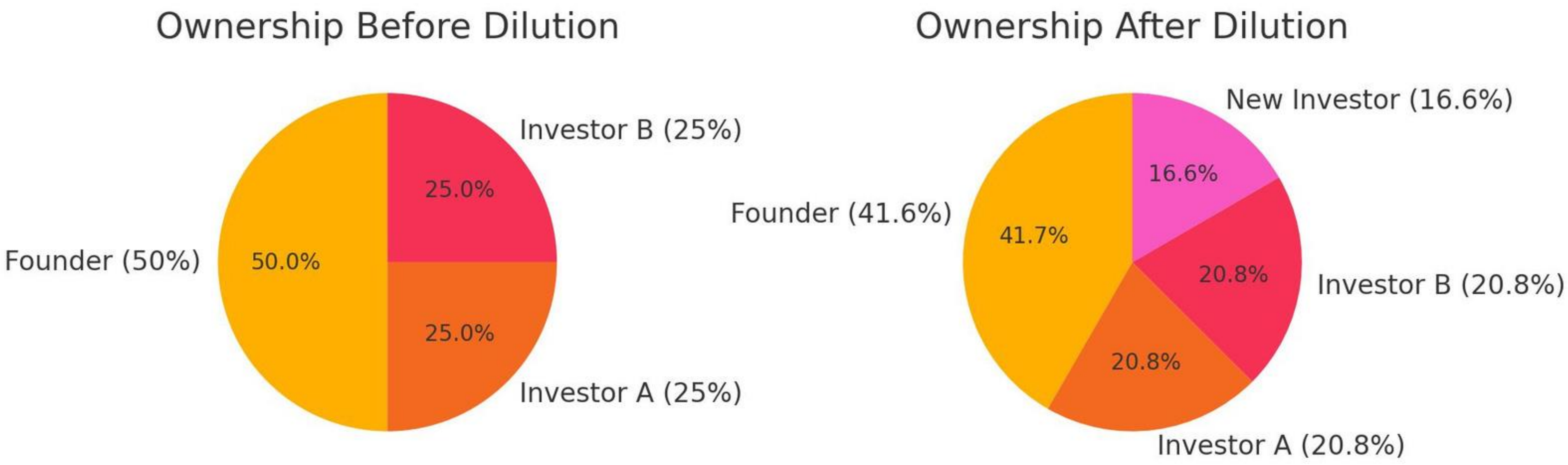
Decreased ownership % of existing shareholders when a startup issues new shares

- Happens during funding rounds when investors receive equity
- Founders and early investors see a reduction in their ownership stake
- Can be managed with anti-dilution clauses or strategic fundraising

Example 1:

- A startup has 1,000,000 shares; a founder owns 50% (500,000 shares).
- The startup raises $1M by issuing 200,000 new shares to investors.
- The founder's new ownership: 500,000 / 1,200,000 = 41.6%
- Founder share is 'diluted' by 8.4% (50% - 41.6%)

Dilution



Before Dilution:

- Total shares = 1,000,000;
- Founder owns 50% (500,000 shares)
- Investor A & Investor B each own 25% (250,000 shares each)

After Dilution:

- Founder now owns 41.6%
- Investor A and B each own 20.8%
  New Investor owns 16.6%

Burn Rate

Rate at which a startup spends its cash reserves before generating positive cash flow.

- A key metric for investors to assess financial health.
- High burn rate without revenue can lead to running out of funds.
- Founders must manage the burn rate to extend the company's runway

Example 1: If a startup spends Rs. 100,000 per month on salaries, rent & marketing, the gross burn rate is Rs. 100K/month

Example 2: If a startup spends Rs. 100,000 per month but generates Rs. 40,000 in revenue, the net burn rate is Rs. 60K/Month

Runway

Runway is the number of months a startup can continue operating before it runs out of cash, assuming no additional revenue or investment.

- Indicates how long a startup has before it needs new funding or must become profitable.
- Directly impacted by burn rate (monthly expenses). Startups with a short runway need raise funds quickly or cut costs to survive.

Formula: $$\text{Runway(months)} = \frac{\text{Cash Balance}}{\text{Burn Rate per Month}}$$

Runway Example

Example1: Startup A

- Cash in the bank: Rs. 500,000
- Burn rate: Rs. 50,000/month
- Monthly revenue: None
- Runway: 500,000 ÷ 50,000 = 10 months

Example2: Startup B (Partially offsetting costs with revenue)

- Cash in the bank: Rs. 500,000
- Burn rate: Rs. 50,000/month
- Monthly revenue: Rs. 10,000
- Net Burn Rate: Rs. 50,000 – Rs. 10,000 = Rs. 40,000
- Runway: 500,000 ÷ 40,000 = 12.5 months

Breakeven

- **Point at which total revenues equal total costs, resulting in neither a profit nor a loss.**
- **It is the level of sales at which a company covers all its fixed and variable costs.**

- Indicates how long a startup has before it needs new funding or must become profitable.
- Helps determine the minimum amount of sales needed to avoid losses
- Particularly important for early-stage startups when cash flow management is critical
- Directly impacted by burn rate (monthly expenses).
- Startups with a short runway need to raise funds quickly or cut costs to survive.

Breakeven

UNDERSTANDING THE BREAKEVEN POINT

EXPRESSED IN UNITS & REVENUE

1. BREAKEVEN IN UNITS SOLD

FORMULA:

$$\text{Breakeven Point (in units)} = \frac{\text{(Fixed Costs)}}{\text{(Selling Price per Unit − Variable Cost per Unit)}}$$

2. BREAKEVEN IN REVENUE

FORMULA:

$$\text{Breakeven Point (in revenue)} = \text{Breakeven Point units} \times \text{Selling Price per Unit}$$

PRACTICAL CASE STUDY: PEN STARTUP

STARTUP DETAILS (INPUTS)

- Fixed Costs: Rs. 100,000 / yr
- Variable Costs: Rs. 5 / pen
- Selling Price: Rs. 15 / pen

CALCULATION (RESULTS)

$$\text{Breakeven Point (in units)} = \frac{\text{Rs. }100{,}000}{(15 - 5)} \rightarrow \textbf{10,000 PENS}$$

$$\text{Breakeven Revenue} = 10{,}000 \times \text{Rs. }15 \rightarrow \textbf{Rs. 150,000}$$

M9 - Briefcase

This week's briefcase - Digital Business Models:

- Any venture/startup needs the right revenue and cash flow to sustain their products and grow at the pace they plan to. It becomes imperative for them to find the right Business Models and choose them with care to be competitive in their chosen market segment.
- In this Brief Case study we present to you a few Digital Business Models that are helping businesses sustain and grow while offering repeatable ways of attracting and retaining customers.
- We also have a few open-ended questions for Students to think about in terms of what business models are apt for problems they are trying to solve.

M9 – BriefCase – Quiz

Menti code: **2165 1689**

PES UNIVERSITY

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

The Art of Startup Finance: Cash Flow
(link)

(Kauffman Foundation, 4:21 m)

Startup Finance Survival

The Art of Startup Finance: Cash Flow
(link)

(Kauffman Foundation, 4:21 m)

Summary

- **Profit vs Cash Flow:** Profit is accounting performance, but **cash flow keeps the business alive**. Startups often fail when cash runs out, even if they appear profitable.
- **Raising Funds via Equity:** Startups can raise capital by **selling a portion of ownership to investors** instead of borrowing money.
- **Startup Valuation:** Valuation represents **what the startup is believed to be worth**, often based on future growth potential rather than current profit.
- **Equity Dilution:** When new investors come in, **founders' ownership percentage decreases**, even though the company may become more valuable.
- **Burn Rate:** The speed at which a startup **spends its available cash to operate and grow**.
- **Runway:** The amount of time a startup can **continue operating before it runs out of cash**, based on its current burn rate.

"Great ideas build startups, but financial awareness keeps them alive."

Expert Talk : Shobana Rajagopal

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP cie

PES UNIVERSITY

Expert Talk : Shobana Rajagopal

Finance Leader, Target India | Ex-Microsoft | Chartered Accountant | 20+ Years in Business Finance

Career Journey

- Finance Leader, Target India — Head of Corporate Accounting & Controllership
- Functional Lead, Statutory & Tax Controllership at Microsoft (10 yrs 9 mos)
- Commercial Finance Lead — Revenue Controllership, SMB, at Microsoft
- Manager FP&A, Oracle | Financial Analyst, Coca-Cola Enterprises (Atlanta)
- Equity Research at Amba Research | FP&A at GE Capital — 20+ yr arc

Domain Expertise

- FP&A · Controllership · Commercial Finance · Revenue Analytics
- Capital funding & FEMA compliance; largest-ever India data center infusion
- AI & Modern Finance — driving digitization & audit readiness at Microsoft India
- SMB/Partner growth strategy: cloud adoption, consumption KPIs, white-space targeting
- Global team leadership: 45-person corp accounting team; 18-member FP&A at Oracle

Education & Credentials

- Chartered Accountant — ICAI (2001–2004) | ~19 yrs in Business Finance
- Certified: M&A Structuring the Deal — New York Institute of Finance (2020)
- LinkedIn Learning: Communicating with Diplomacy and Tact (2020)
- 26 skills endorsed: GAAP · Corporate Finance · Business Analysis · Strategy
- Cross-sector exposure: Retail, Tech, FMCG, Supply Chain, Investment Banking

What Peers Say

- *"Driven, focused, reliable... always willing to put in extra effort." — Crystal Ni, Oracle*
- *"Extremely quick learner... would be within top 5 people I have worked with." — Arindam Ghosh*
- *"Looks beyond her own remit... dares to ask for help when needed." — Jorrin Lippens, Oracle*
- Known for championing AI adoption, financial storytelling, and cross-cultural leadership

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Expert Talk : Aditya Mehta

PES UNIVERSITY

Expert Talk : Aditya Mehta

Designation:

Co-Founder , Epicure Robotics

Achievements and Recognitions:

1.Innovator in Robotics, Automation & Mechatronics

- Driven by a passion for solving real-world problems through tech, this founder is revolutionizing food automation as Co-Founder of Epicure Robotics.
- Building automated robotic food kiosks in India to deliver healthy, personalized meals with ultra-convenience.
- For 3 years, they've led mechanical design and robotics efforts at the startup.

Leadership & Technical Contributions:

- IEEE RAS PES University
    - Student Head (2021–2022): Led 35+ teammates and 700+ community members.
- Systemantics India Pvt. Ltd.
    - Embedded Systems Intern (2021–2022): Worked on industrial robotics and embedded tech.

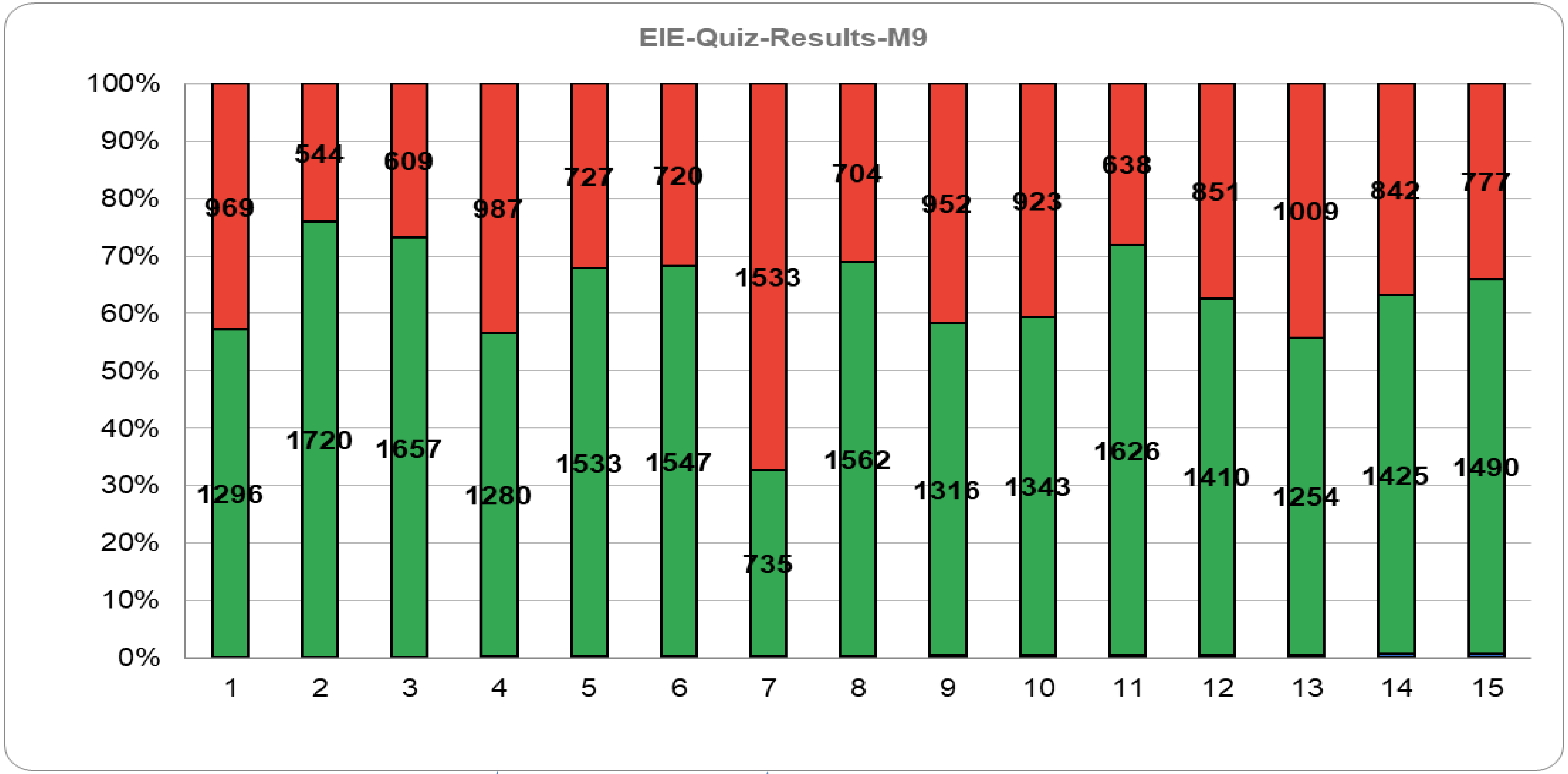
CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

PES UNIVERSITY

Essentials of Innovation & Entrepreneurship (EIE) - II

Module (M10): Digital Marketing

M9 Recap – Session End Quiz



M9 Recap – Session End Quiz

4. A startup owns machinery, office buildings, and production equipment that are used for long-term operations rather than daily transactions. These types of assets are usually categorized as which of the following?

a) Current assets
b) Liquid assets
c) Fixed assets **-** 1280 students got it right!
d) Temporary assets

7. A startup founder is tracking performance and forecasting future needs to avoid cash shortages. This practice is specifically referred as?

a) Managing Profitably
b) Deciding with data **-** 735 students got it right!
c) Growth Chart
d) Critical accounting

13. When founders raise money by selling a portion of their company to investors, their percentage ownership may decrease after each funding round. What is this process called?

a) Inflation
b) Dilution **-** 1254 students got it right!
c) Expansion
d) Consolidation

M9 Recap – Menti Quiz

Menti code: 8894 0000

M9 Recap

Finance Basics

- Decide with data
- Track performance
- Forecast funding needs
- Avoid cash shortages

Profit vs Cash Flow

- Profit = revenue − expenses
- Cash Flow = actual money in/out
- A startup can be profitable but still fail due to cash shortage

Valuation & Equity

- Pre-money: value before investment
- Post-money: value after investment
- Investment → investor ownership
- New funding → dilution of founder stake

Key Startup Metrics

- Burn Rate: monthly cash spending
- Runway: months before cash runs out
- Runway = Cash ÷ Burn Rate

Breakeven

- Revenue = total costs
- Minimum sales needed to sustain the business

Marketing – A Recap

Marketing is the act of acquiring, satisfying and retaining customers.

The Marketing flow

- Understand → What problems or needs exist?
- Design → What solution fits best?
- Signal → How do we make people want it?

Why Marketing ?

“Most businesses get zero distribution channels to work …
if you can get even one channel to work,
you have a great business.”
-Peter Thiel

Peter Thiel is the cofounder of Paypal and Palantir and an Early investor in Facebook

Why Marketing?

Scenario	Outcome	Relatable Examples
Great product + Zero distribution	Nobody hears about it	A student builds an amazing productivity app but never puts it on Google Play Store or promotes it—only friends know it exists
Decent product + Strong distribution	Startup grows	A campus bubble tea stall with decent taste but strong Instagram presence and student influencer promotions—steady crowd daily
Great product + Strong distribution	Massive company	Apple Inc. launching the iPhone: strong product + global marketing + anticipation → massive success
Bad product + Strong distribution	Short-term growth → churn	A heavily advertised food delivery brand with poor quality—people try once due to ads but don't reorder (high churn)

Think...

"Think of a product you recently bought without much thinking."

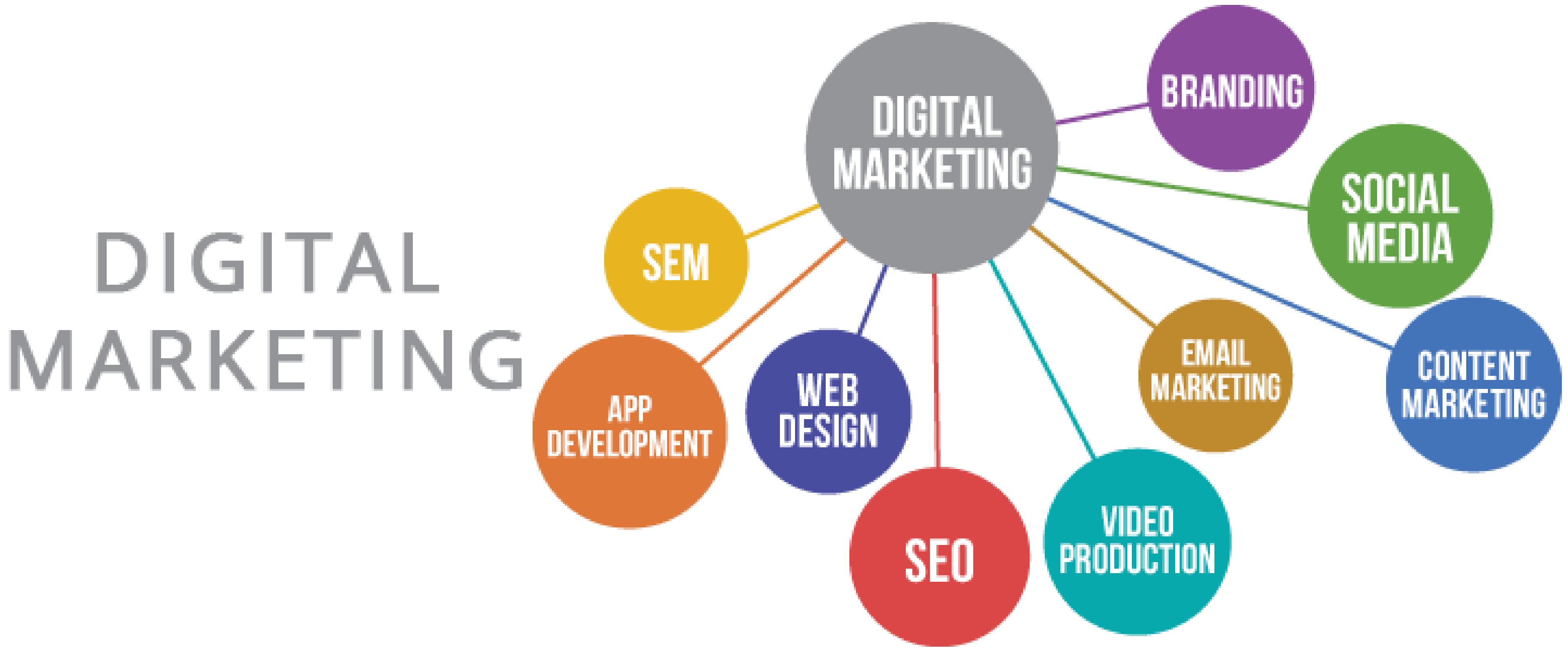
- Why did you want it?
- Where did you first see it?
- What convinced you?

Traditional Marketing

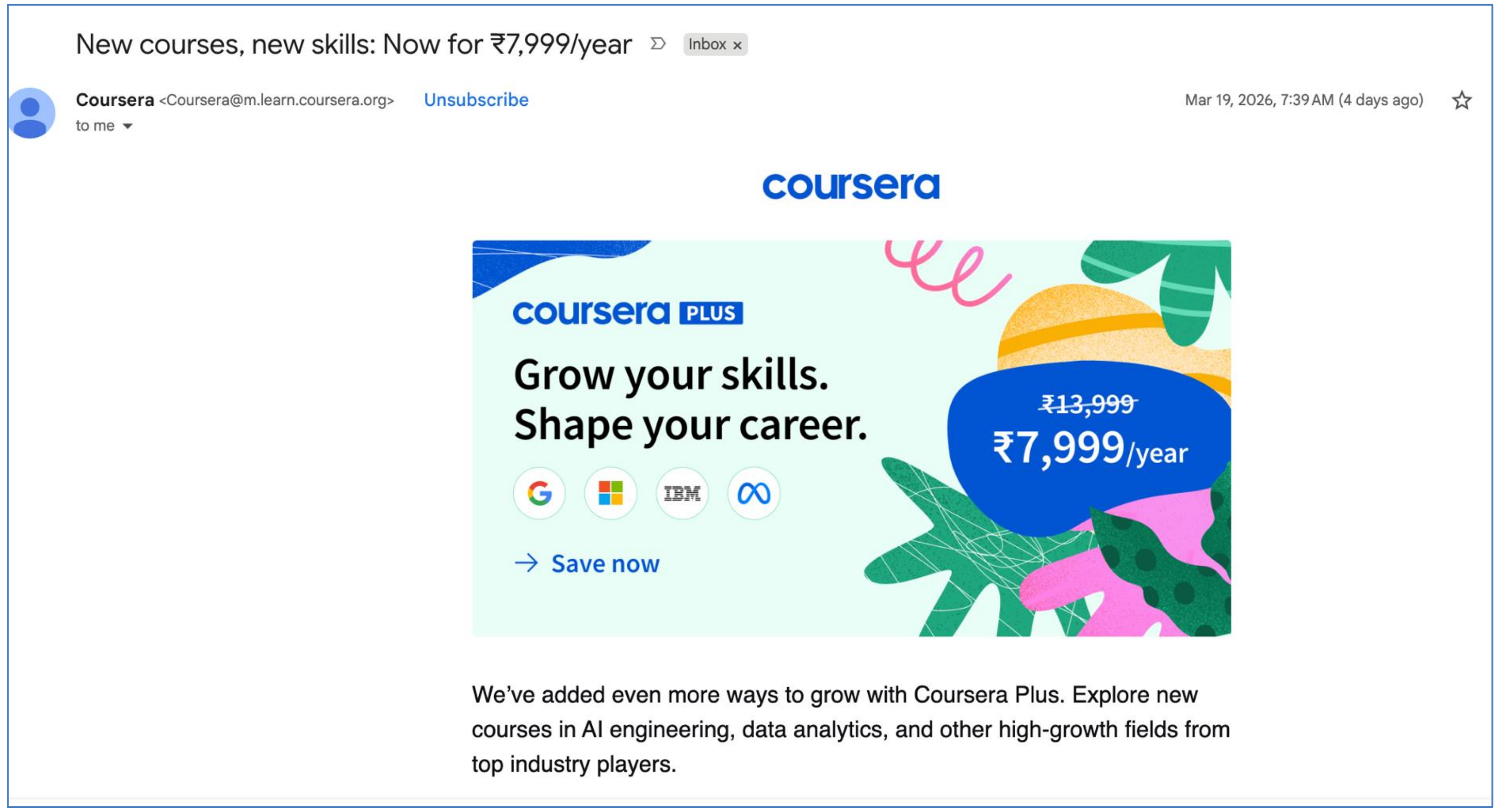
- Traditional marketing refers to conventional, offline promotional methods used to reach a broad audience, such as print ads, television commercials, radio, billboards, and direct mail.

What is Digital Marketing ?

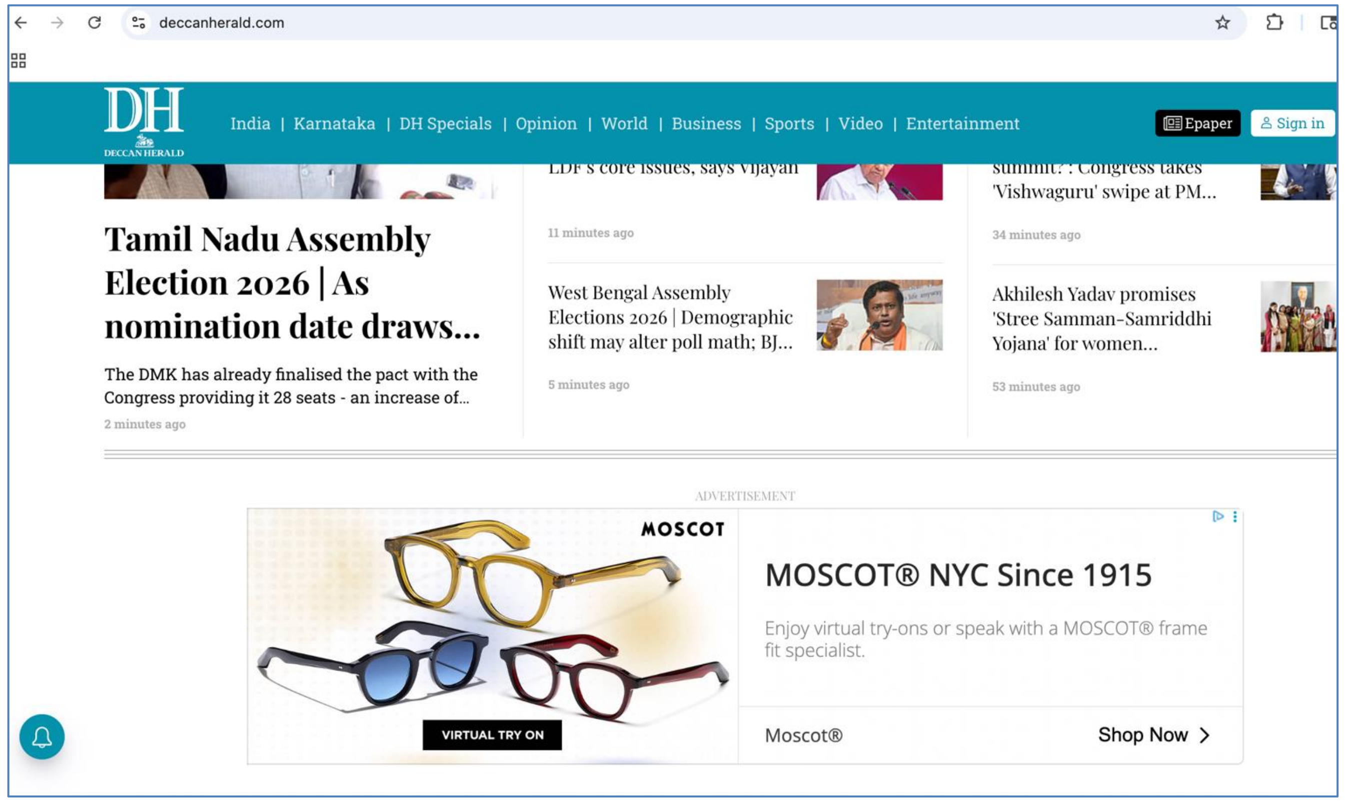
- Digital Marketing is also known as Online Marketing/Internet Marketing/Web Marketing is primarily used to promote businesses online on various online marketing platforms such as Google, Google's content delivery network, various social media platforms and so on.
- Use of media to engage with consumers through online channels such as, search engines, social media, email, and their websites to connect with current and prospective customers.



Example?



New courses, new skills: Now for ₹7,999/year
Inbox ×
Coursera <Coursera@m.learn.coursera.org>
Unsubscribe
to me
Mar 19, 2026, 7:39 AM (4 days ago)
coursera
coursera PLUS
Grow your skills.
Shape your career.
IBM
₹13,999
₹7,999/year
Save now
We've added even more ways to grow with Coursera Plus. Explore new courses in AI engineering, data analytics, and other high-growth fields from top industry players.



deccanherald.com
DH
DECCAN HERALD
India | Karnataka | DH Specials | Opinion | World | Business | Sports | Video | Entertainment
Epaper
Sign in
Tamil Nadu Assembly Election 2026 | As nomination date draws...
The DMK has already finalised the pact with the Congress providing it 28 seats - an increase of...
2 minutes ago
11 minutes ago
West Bengal Assembly Elections 2026 | Demographic shift may alter poll math; BJ...
5 minutes ago
'Vishwaguru' swipe at PM...
34 minutes ago
Akhilesh Yadav promises 'Stree Samman-Samriddhi Yojana' for women...
53 minutes ago
ADVERTISEMENT
MOSCOT
VIRTUAL TRY ON
MOSCOT® NYC Since 1915
Enjoy virtual try-ons or speak with a MOSCOT® frame fit specialist.
Moscot®
Shop Now

Neemans
Sponsored
RapidCruise™ midsole absorbs impact. CloudSurge™ foam bounces back. Pressure-mapped outsole grips strong. Meet Begin Walk Pulse.
NEEMAN'S
FOR 7AM WALK CLUBS.
AND 9PM BOARDING GATES.
BEGIN WALK
PULSE

Traditional and Digital Marketing

Dimension	Traditional	Digital
Reach	Local / Mass	Global / Targeted
Targeting	Broad	Highly specific
Interaction	One-way	Two-way
Cost	High	Flexible / Lower
Measurement	Delayed	Real-time
Control	User cannot skip	Skippable/user control

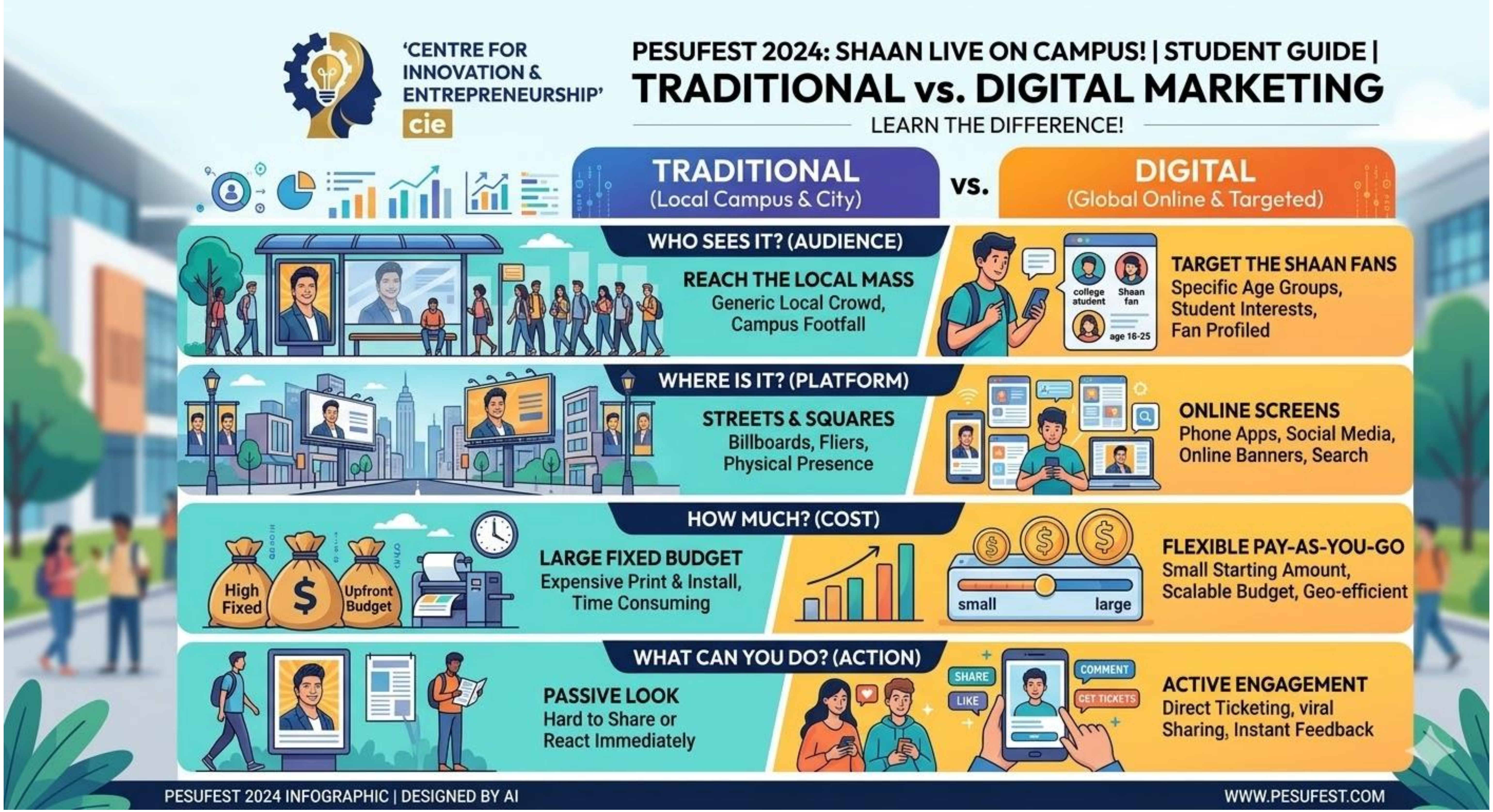
Traditional = Broadcast
Digital = Conversation + Precision

"So the shift is not just from offline to online—it is from broadcasting to understanding and adapting."

Think…

“If you had ₹1000 to promote your idea today—would you print posters or run Instagram ads? Why?”

Traditional vs Digital Marketing – a PESU Example



Marketing Plan

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

PES UNIVERSITY

Introduction to Digital Marketing

Traction Channels

- A **traction channel** is the method or pathway through which you acquire customers for your product.

- Simply put, they are: "Where and how do users discover and start using your product?"

"A startup doesn't grow because of one channel—it grows when it finds the channel that works best for its audience."

Traction Channels

Channel	What it Means
SEO (Search Engine Optimization)	Getting discovered when people search online (Google etc)
Content Marketing	Blogs, videos, reels that attract and educate users
Paid Ads	Paying platforms like Instagram or Google Ads to show your product
Social Media	Organic posts, reels, engagement on platforms
Community based Marketing (CBM)	Building or leveraging groups (WhatsApp, Discord, campus clubs)
Referrals	Existing users bringing new users ("Invite a friend")
Sales (Direct Outreach)	Personally reaching out (calls, demos, pitches)
Events / Activations	Stalls, campus events, launch activities

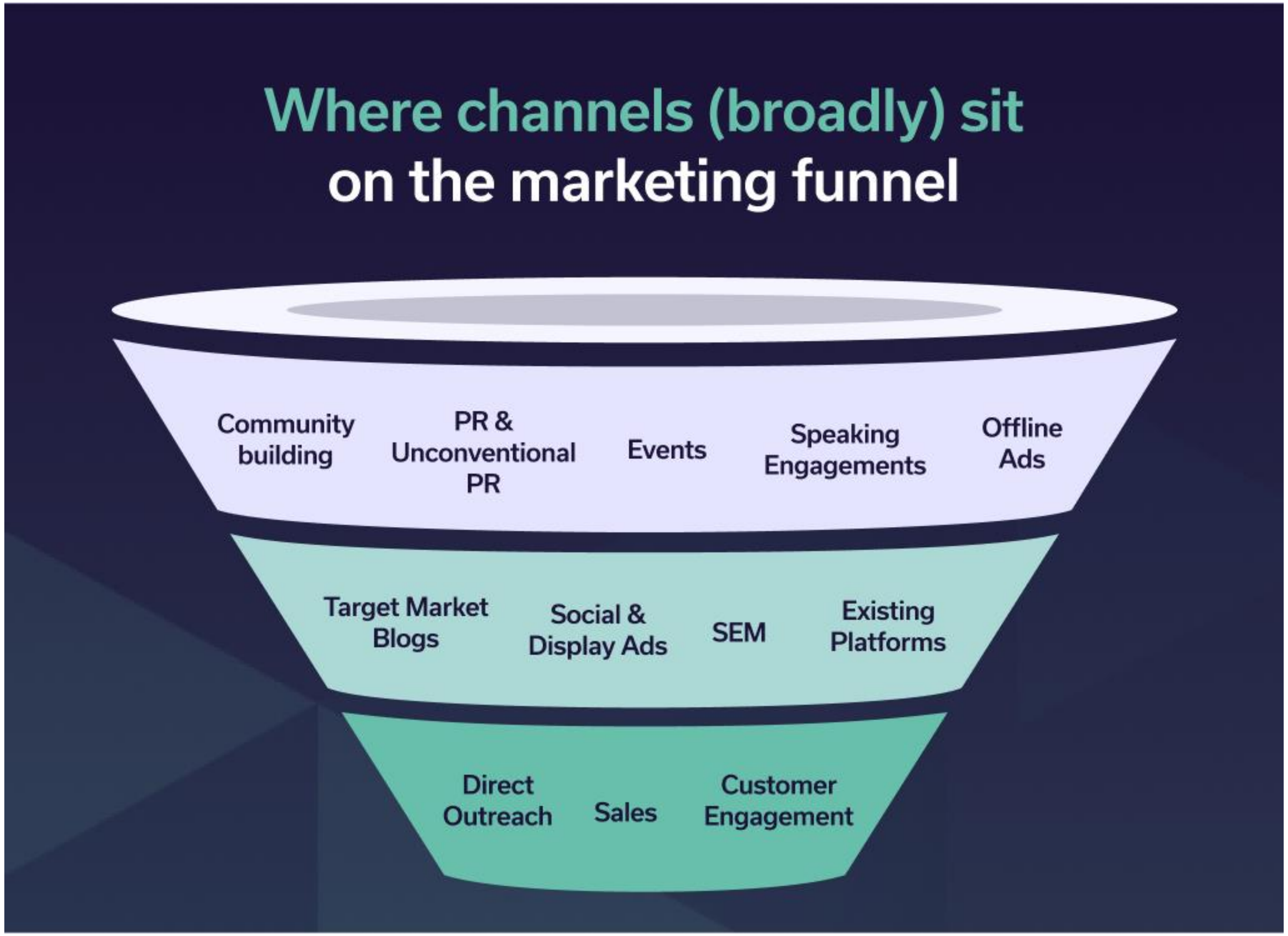
Having early traction is a sign that you have a product that people want to use. Also, early startup traction acts as insurance for VCs and their investment.

Traction Channels

Talk is cheap, but traction is hard evidence that you’re on the right path.

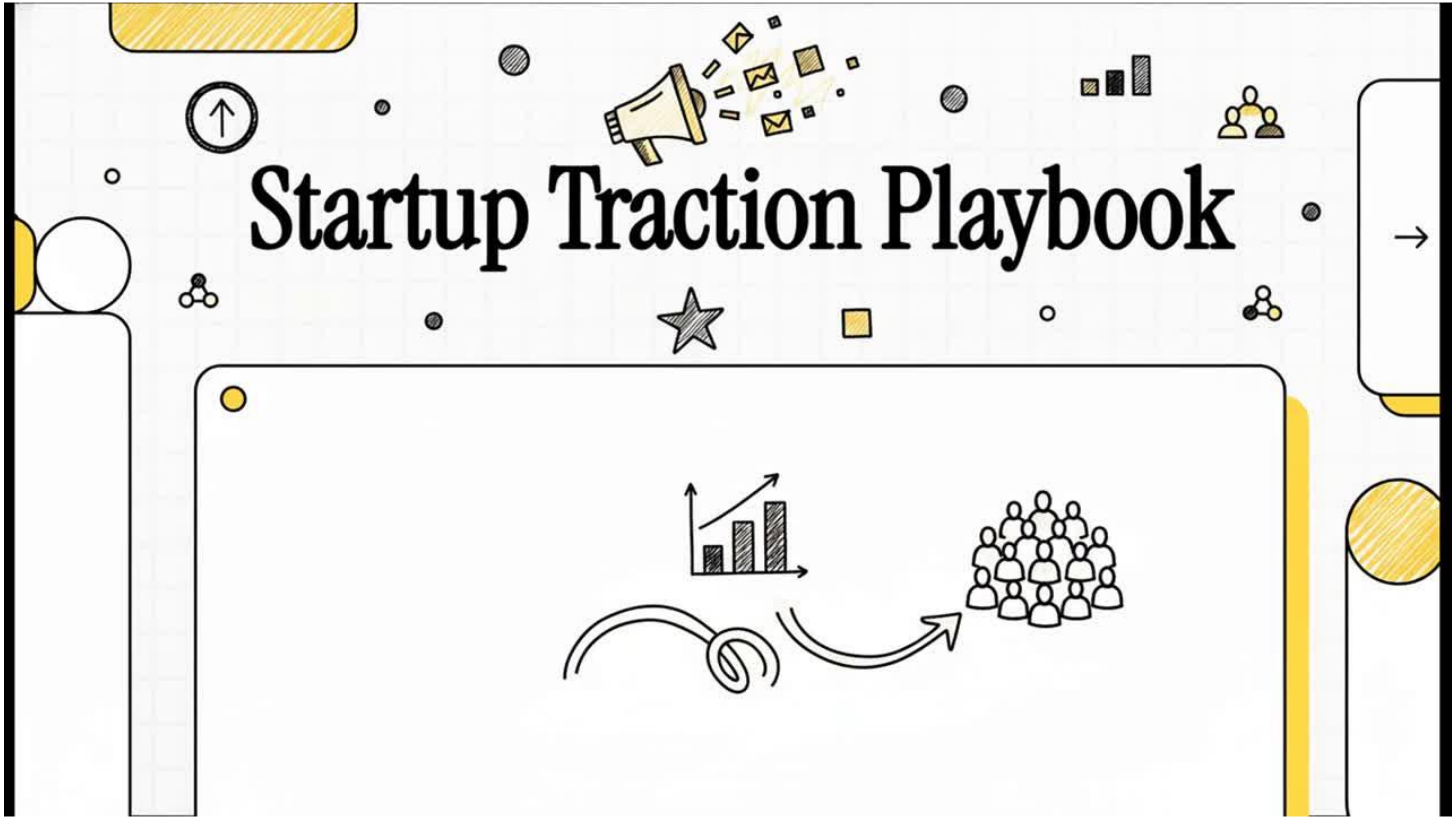
https://www.amazon.in/Traction-Startup-Achieve-Explosive-Customer/dp/1591848369

Traction Channels



Traction Channels - Summary

Startup Traction



Organic Traction – Growth Powered by Time, Not Money

- **Content & SEO –** Be the answer they Google (1 useful article/video per week).
- **Organic Social** – Founder posts + engages on 1–2 platforms consistently.
- **Communities & Forums** – Help in relevant groups, then mention what you're building.
- **Referrals** – Ask happy users to invite 1 friend; make sharing one-click.
- **Partnerships** – Cross-promote with complementary products, clubs or newsletters.

Organic Traction – Growth Powered by Time, Not Money

Quick-start action plan

- Pick 1–2 tactics to start (content + one social channel works well)
- Set small goals (publish one post a week, answer one community question daily)
- Track results: traffic, sign-ups, referrals
- Double down on what works
- Be patient — these tactics compound over time

Use time + creativity, not money, to get your first waves of users.

Mixed Traction-
Borrowed Attention

- **Partnerships** – Cross-promote with complementary products, clubs, newsletters or communities; swap shout-outs, bundles, or guest content.
- **Events & Webinars** – Run or co-host workshops, AMAs, demos (online or on campus) to educate and collect sign-ups.
- **Creators / Micro-Influencers** – Collaborate with small, niche creators your users already trust; start with value (free access, co-content), add budget only if it works.
- **Product-Led Growth (PLG)** – Use free tiers/trials and built-in invite/share loops so the product itself pulls in more users.

Paid Traction-
When Money Makes Sense

- **Search Ads (Google, etc.)** – Bid on keywords your best customers search (high intent, high cost); only after you know which keywords and landing pages convert.
- **Social & Display Ads** – Use Meta/LinkedIn/YouTube/other networks to quickly test audiences and messages before scaling.
- **Sponsorships & Paid Placements** – Pay for visibility in newsletters, podcasts, events or niche sites your users follow.
- **Paid Affiliates** – Give partners/creators a commission for every customer they bring (performance-based spend).

Metrics for Digital Marketing

"If you can't measure it, you can't improve it."

🎯 1. Know What's Working (and What's Not)

Not all campaigns succeed
Metrics show what actually drives results
👉 Avoid guessing

🔍 2. Make Better Decisions

Which channel to focus on?
What to stop, what to scale?
👉 Data replaces assumptions

💰 3. Control Cost & Improve ROI

Are we spending too much to get customers?
Are we making money or losing money?
👉 Connect marketing to business outcomes

"Digital marketing is powerful because everything is measurable."

M10 – BriefCase – UNIQLO

- **Seamless Omnichannel Integration:** UNIQLO bridges the gap between online and offline shopping by allowing customers to use the mobile app to **check real-time in-store stock**, read peer reviews, and choose "click-and-collect" options for easy store pickup.

- **AI-Powered Personalization:** The digital strategy utilizes browsing history to provide **tailored style suggestions**, while in-store AI size finders and **smart mirrors** help customers visualize different colors and fits, significantly improving the user experience and reducing returns.

- **Community-Led Social Media:** Rather than aggressive sales pitches, UNIQLO uses platforms like Instagram and YouTube to share **styling tips and behind-the-scenes content**, while heavily leveraging **User-Generated Content (UGC)** and local influencers who reflect the brand's "LifeWear" values.

- **Utility-Driven Mobile App:** The brand's app serves as a functional tool rather than just a storefront, offering advanced features like **advance fitting room booking**, saved style combinations, and personalized product nudges based on local weather or travel plans.

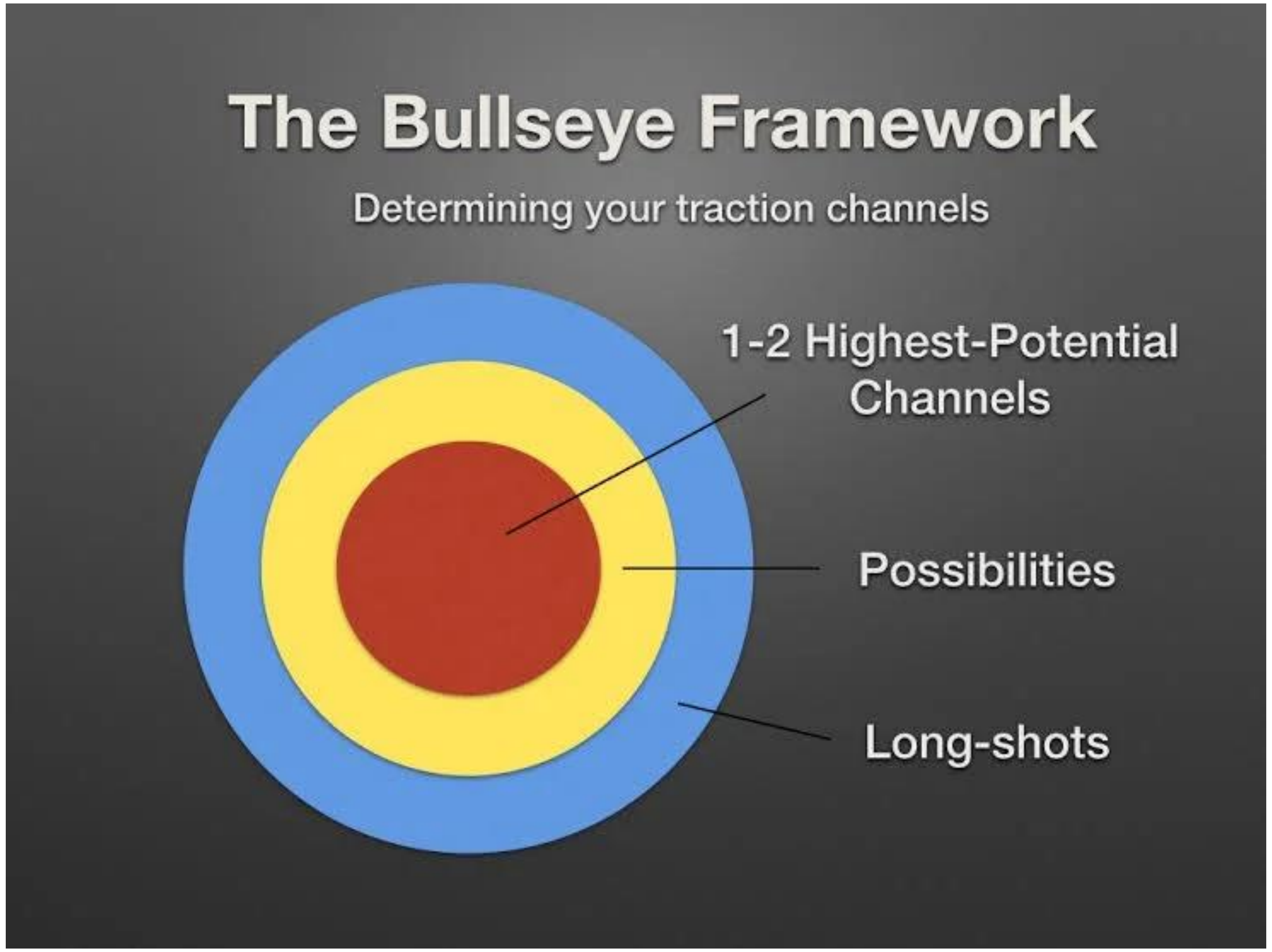
- **"Quiet" Digital Communication:** Eschewing the "hype" of typical fast-fashion marketing, UNIQLO maintains a **clean, minimal digital aesthetic** that focuses on the functional benefits of its technology (like HEATTECH) and consistent storytelling to build long-term consumer trust.

M10 – BriefCase - Quiz

Menti code: 5886 2472

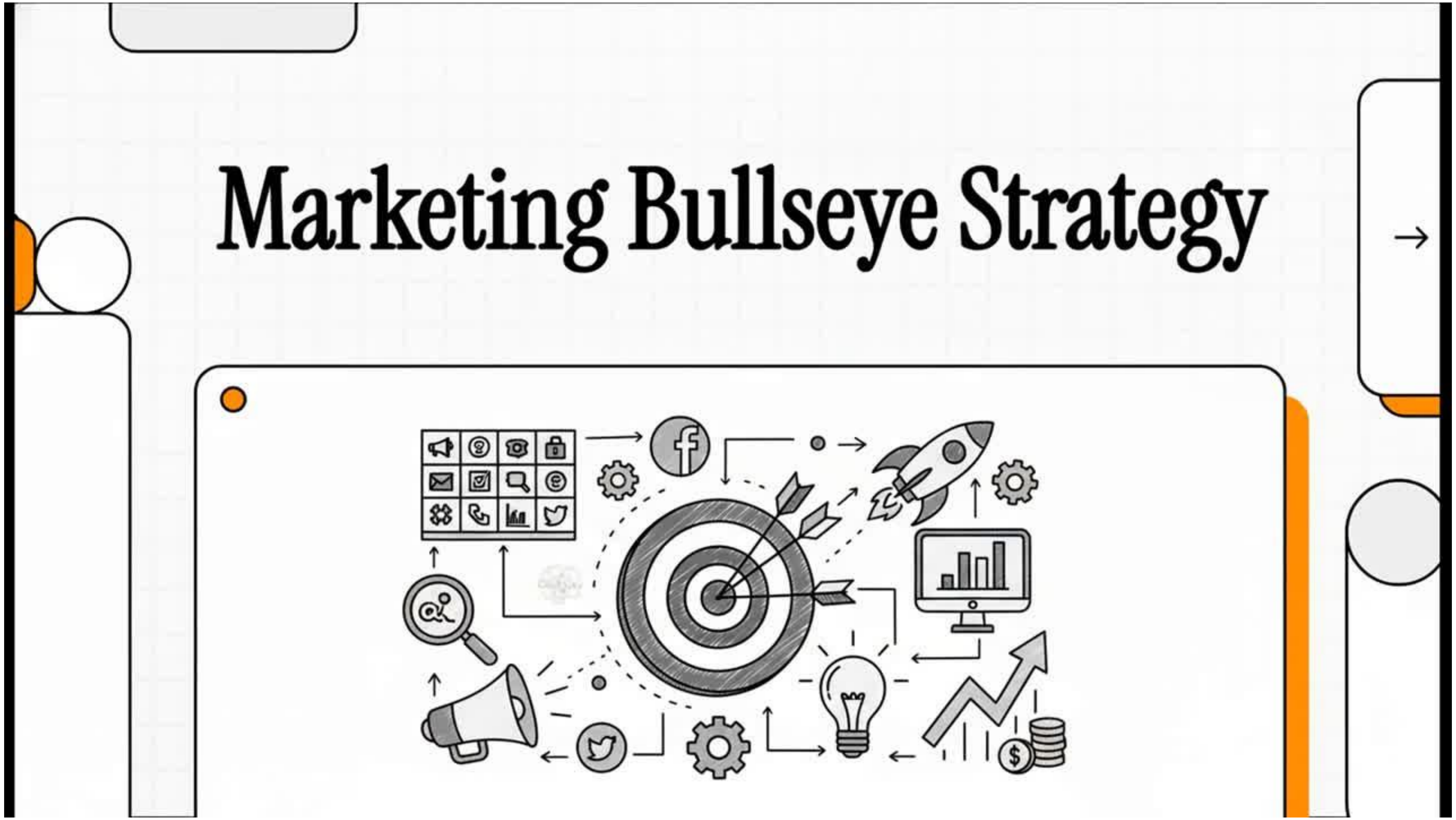
Metrics for Digital Marketing

Channel Strategy - Bullseye Framework



"With 19 channels available, the real challenge is choosing the right one."

Channel Strategy - Bullseye Framework



Keywords and Digital Marketing

- **Keywords** are the words or phrases people type into search engines to find something.
  - "best bubble tea near me"
  - "low sugar drinks for students"

- **Keywords in Content Marketing**
  - Help your content **get discovered organically** (via Google Search)
  - Align your content with **what users are already searching for**
  - Improve visibility through **SEO (Search Engine Optimization)**
  - Drive **free, long-term traffic**
  - Example:
    - Blog: "Top 5 Bubble Tea Flavors for First-Time Drinkers"

- **Keywords in Google Ads**
  - Used to **target users with high intent**
  - Your ad shows when someone searches that keyword via Google Ads
  - Enables **precise targeting** (location, intent, device)
  - Drives **immediate traffic and conversions**
  - Example:
    - Ad triggered by: "bubble tea near campus"

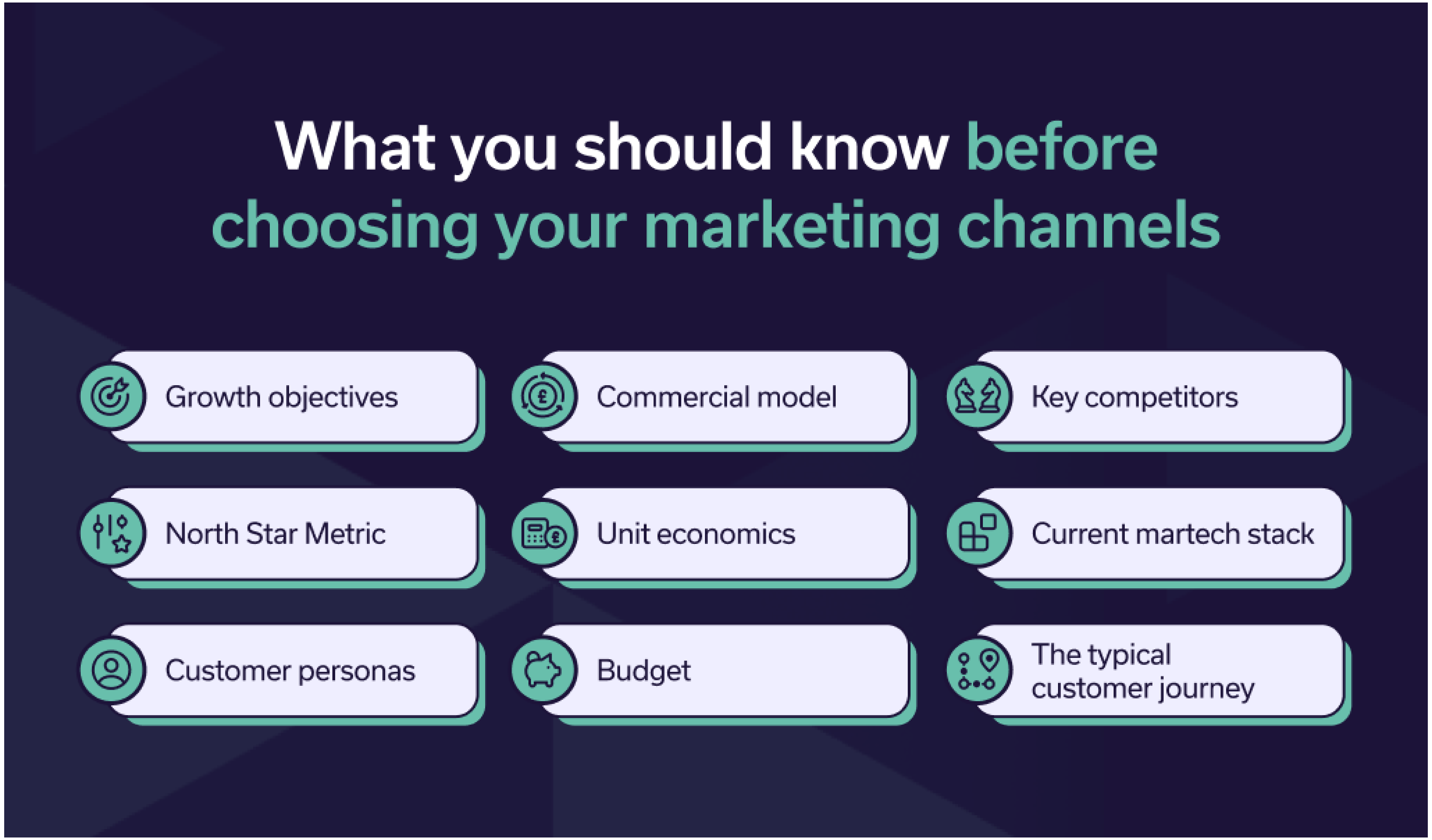
CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

PES UNIVERSITY

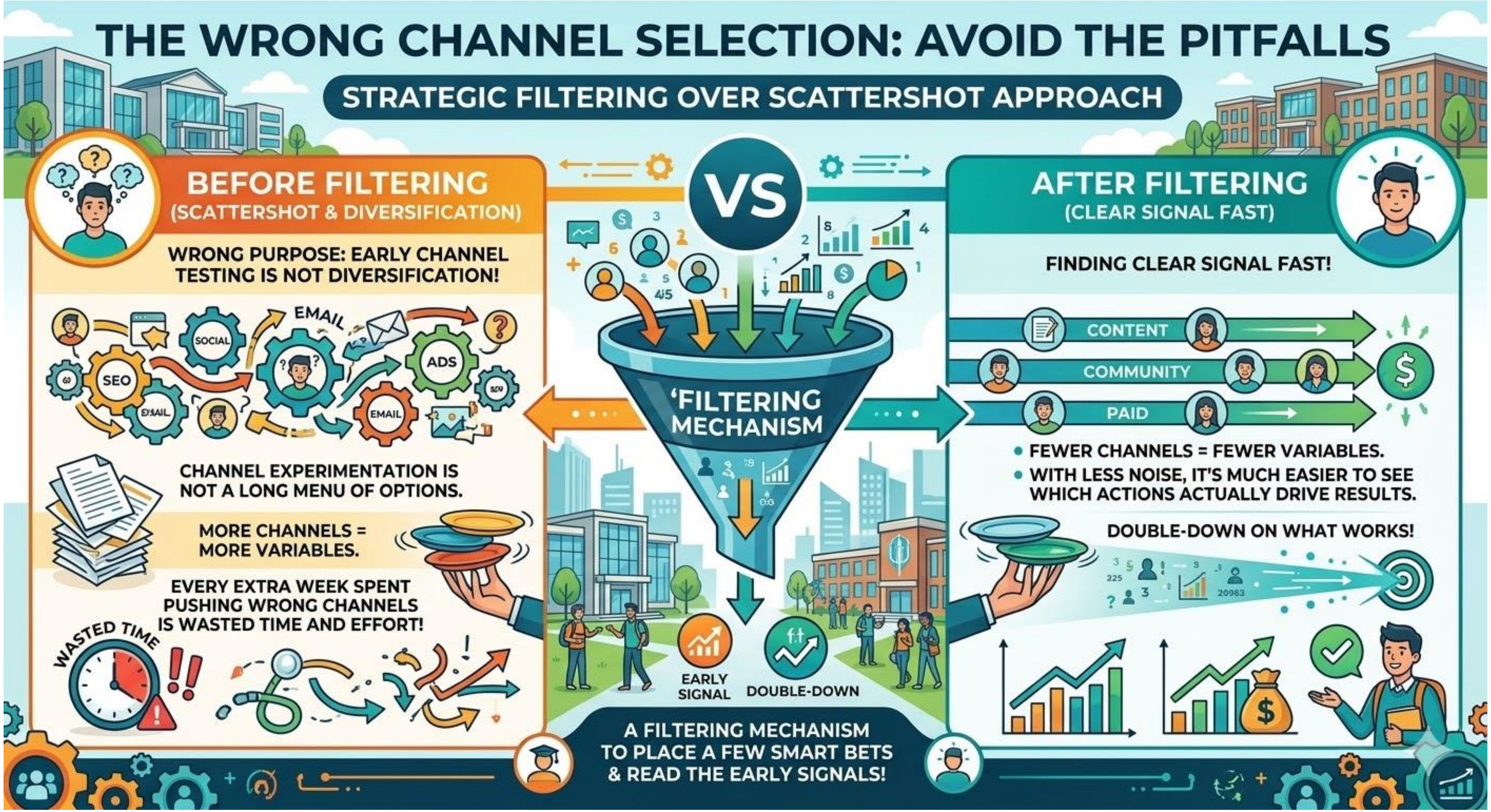
Channel Strategy

Treat channels as experiments, not commitments.

Channel Strategy



The Wrong Channel



The Wrong Channel

'The most common marketing mistake early-stage startups make isn't doing the wrong thing — it's doing too many things.'

- Channel experimentation is not about building a long menu of options; it's a filtering mechanism to place a few smart bets, read the early signals, and double-down on what works.
- Fewer channels = fewer variables. With less noise, it's much easier to see which actions actually drive results.
- So the purpose of early channel testing isn't "diversification"; it's finding clear signal fast – because every extra week spent pushing the wrong channels is wasted time and effort.

The Wrong Channel

Could misaligned channels be draining your marketing budget?

44%
of ad budget wasted on poor targeting

57%
of video ads go unwatched

43.9%
of ad clickers immediately bounce

Source: https://www.clarify.ai/blog/channel-experimentation-trap

3 keys to smart channel experimentation

1. Run actual experiments, not random efforts

a. Define what success looks like

b. Document your exact approach

c. Set a specific timeframe (often 3-6 months)

d. Measure both effort and results

2. Start with founder-channel fit

a. Too many founders try channels they hate, execute inconsistently, then wonder why results disappoint.

b. Do what gives you energy first. You'll do more of it and likely do it better.

3. Measure impact-to-effort ratio

a. Small effort → Large impact = Double down immediately

b. Large effort → Small impact = Cut it quickly

The Founder-Channel Matrix

High fit ↗
Channels that match your natural strengths and give you energy
Start here | Compound over time

Medium fit
Channels you can execute but require more discipline
Add later | Structure required

Low fit ↘
Channels that drain you and will be abandoned when hard
Delegate | Avoid early

Smart channel Experimentation

Design your acquisition channel plan:

Channel: ______________ (e.g., WhatsApp groups, LinkedIn DMs, campus event).

Audience: ______________ (specific people/segment).

Offer: ______________ (what you'll give or promise).

Call-to-action: ______________ (what they should do).

Metric: ______________ (what success looks like).

Time window & volume: "We will run this from ___ to ___ and reach out to ___ people."

Expert Talk : Harsha Chaturvedi

Expert Talk : Harsha Chaturvedi

Career Journey

- **Founder & CEO, 4Good.ai** — Leveraging AI for social good solutions (Present)
- **Founder, EOX Vantage** — Executive leadership in enterprise software (Oct 2002–Jun 2024; 21+ yrs)
- **CTO, PES University** (Current)
- **Executive Technology Leadership** — Previous roles at Fidelity Investments, Sabre, i2 Technologies
- **30+ years experience** in AI, ML, and Enterprise Architecture

Domain Expertise

- **AI & ML Transformation** — Strategic application and deployment
- **Enterprise Systems & Architecture** — Designing scalable, high-performance platforms
- **Technology Advisory & Consulting** — Digital transformation and complex problem solving
- **Operational Excellence & Process Optimization** — Enhancing efficiency with technology
- **Industry Sectors** — Finance, Travel, Supply Chain, Education

Education & Credentials

- **MBA** — Southern Methodist University (SMU), Dallas
- **M.S., Computer Science** — Louisiana State University (LSU), Baton Rouge
- **B.E., Electronics Engineering** — B.M.S. College of Engineering (BMS), Bangalore
- **Holder of 5 US Patents** in AI, marketplace systems, and organization management.
- **Professional Networks** — 2,250+ LinkedIn followers.

PES UNIVERSITY

CELEBRATING 50 YEARS

Essentials of Innovation & Entrepreneurship (EIE) - II

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

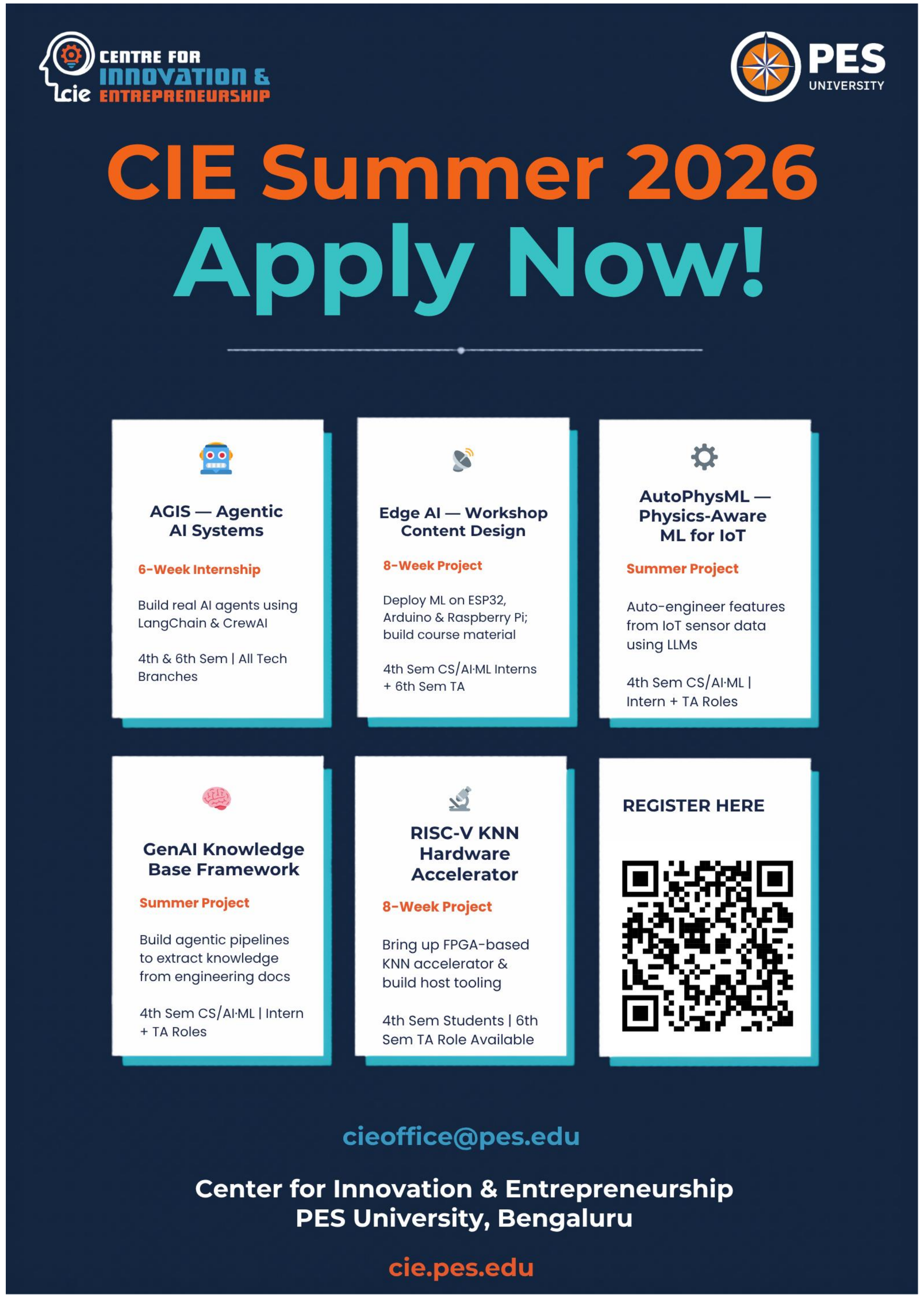
cie

Module (M11): Intellectual Property (IP) for Startups

EIE2-Icebreaker:

I&E Roundup this Week (Apr 08)

Don’t Apply for Jobs. Build One.



Source: CIE

Nothing here clicks?
Create something that does!

Come talk to us @ CIE ☺

AI and You (Innovator/Entrepreneur)

Seize the Moment!

A decade ago, building a startup required funding, a team, and months of effort.

Today*, a student with a laptop and AI tools can validate an idea in a weekend.*

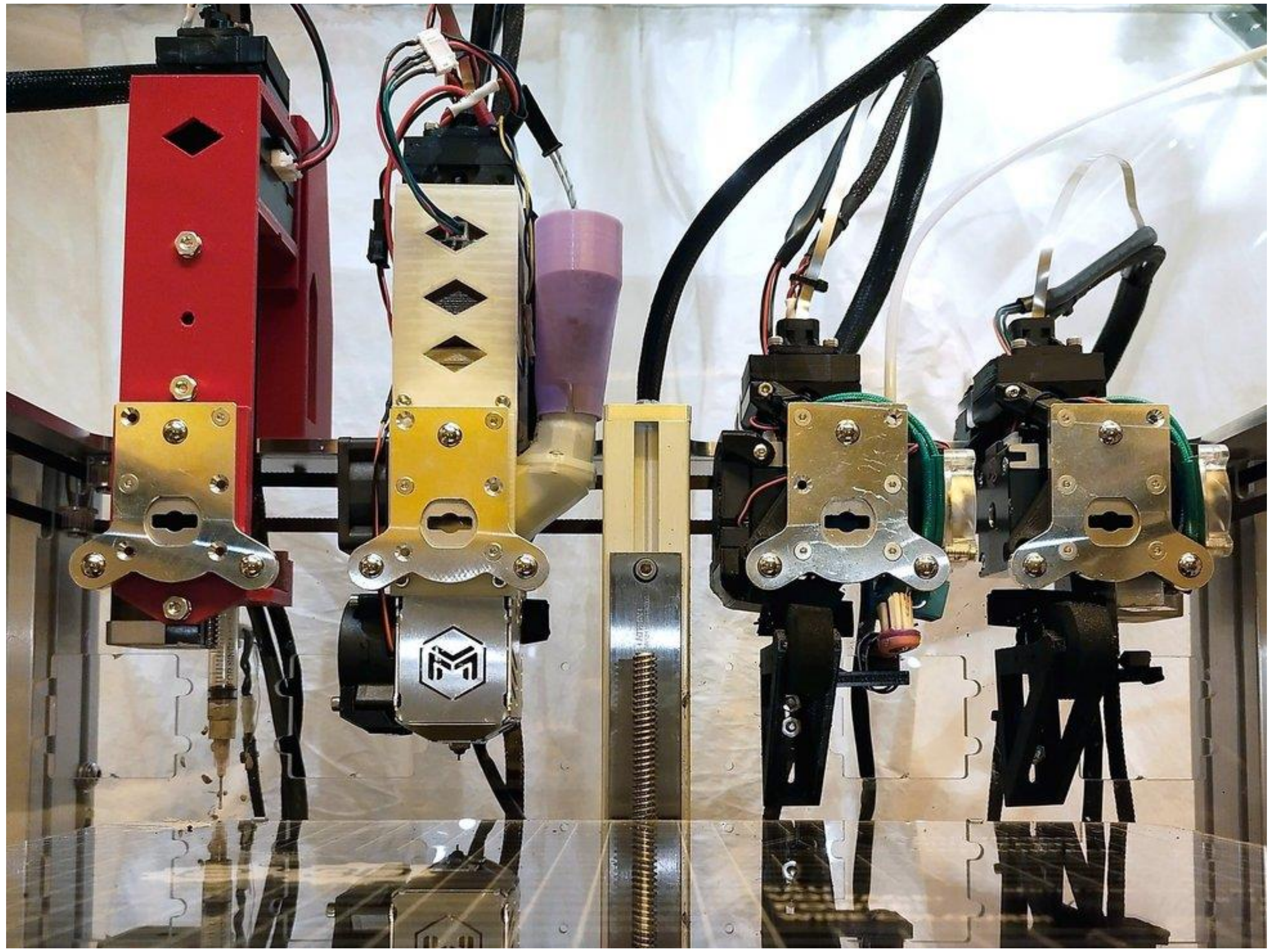
'Jobs to Value Creation' in the Era of AI

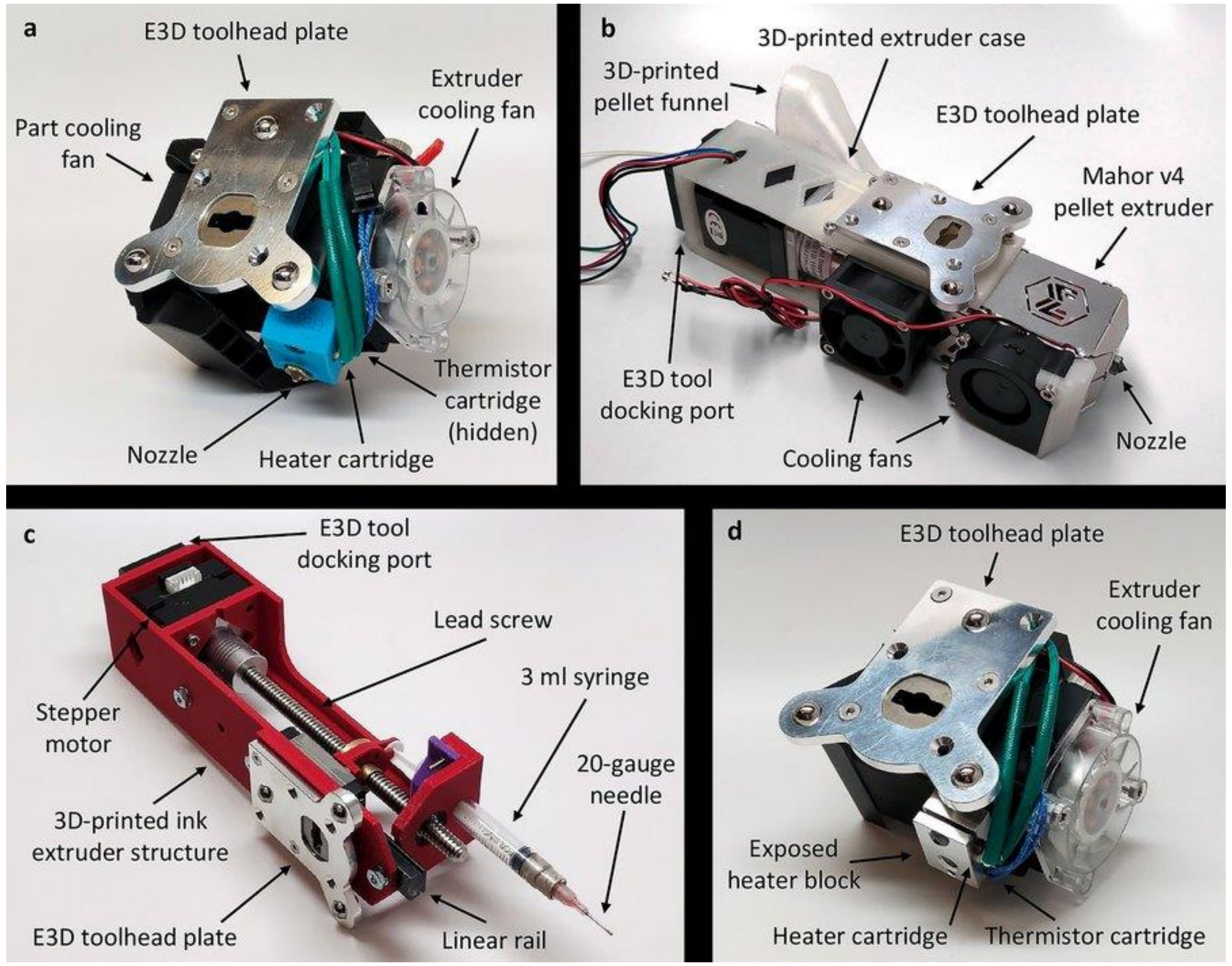
Traditional mindset:
"What job will I get?"

Entrepreneurial mindset:
"What problem can I solve using AI?"

Your Own Factory…in Your Home or Office!

Sophisticated 3D Printers Coming



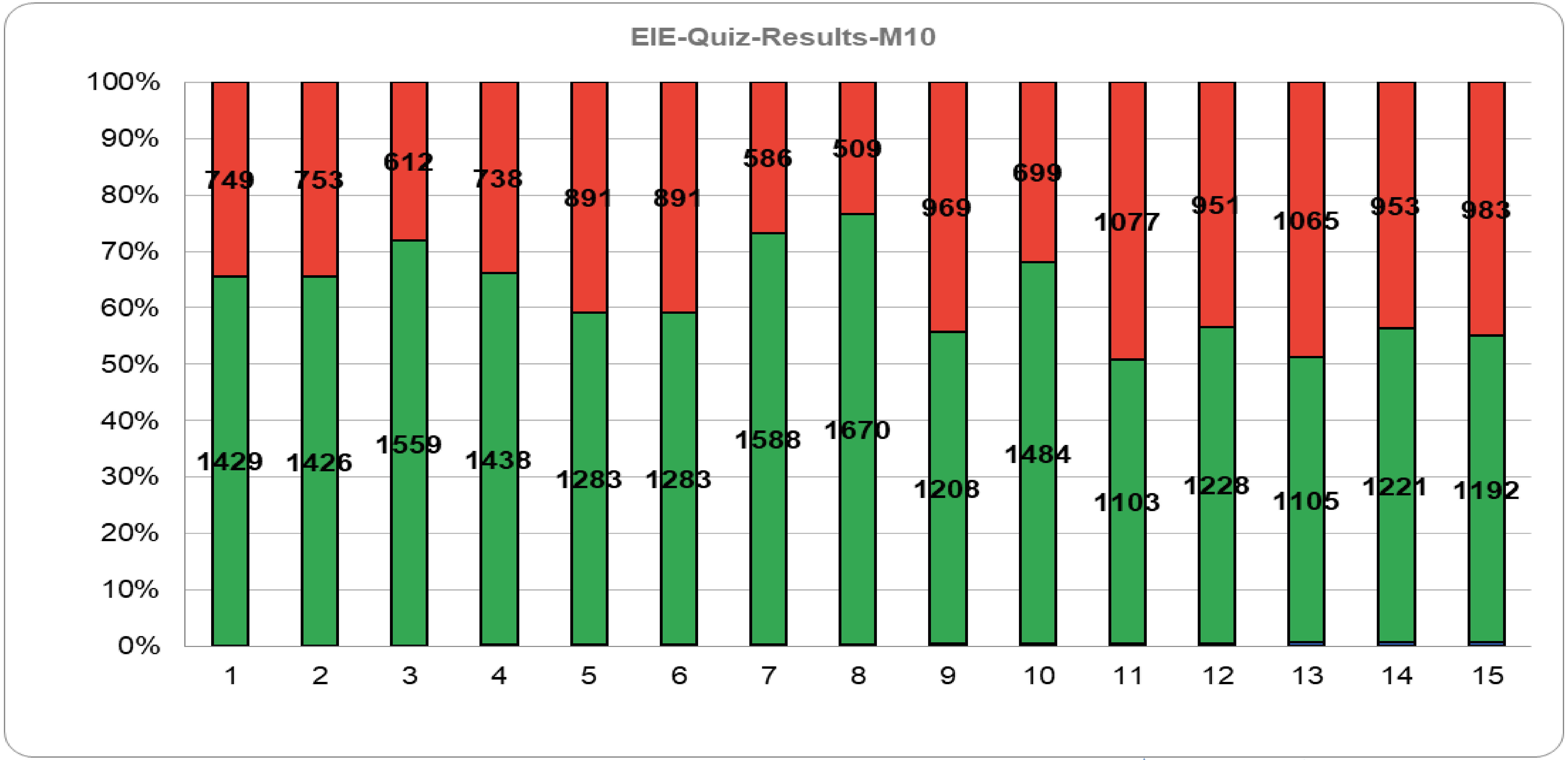


"3D-Printed Motor Platform Could Speed Up Hardware Production
MIT's tool prints distinct materials to build a working motor"

Source: [MIT]

EIE – II – Jan 2026 semester

EIE M10 Session Quiz - Discussion / Recap



EIE - II - Jan 2026 semester

EIE M10 Session Quiz - Discussion / Recap

11. In the Bullseye Framework for channel strategy, what does the "Outer Ring" represent?

a) Selecting 3-4 realistic mixed channel options
b) Doubling down on 1-2 highly successful paths
c) **Brainstorming all possible traction channels** - 1103 students got it right!
d) Discarding all offline advertising methods

13. When evaluating the "impact-to-effort ratio" of an experiment, what should you do if it requires "Small effort" but yields "Large impact"?

a) Avoid the channel completely
b) Stop the marketing experiment
c) **Double down immediately** - 1105 students got it right!
d) Investigate the failure rate

15. If you ask your users to invite one friend to your app, which organic tactic are you primarily using?

a) Search Engine Optimization
b) Paid Partnership Placement
c) **A Referral mechanism** - 1192 students got it right!
d) Social Display Advertising

M10 – Digital Marketing - Recap

Strong distribution > great product (no reach = no growth)

Plan:
- Audience (who)
- Positioning (value)
- Channels (where)
- Content (how)
- Metrics (what works)

Metrics:
- CAC = cost to acquire a customer
- LTV = value from a customer

Traction Channels:
- Organic: SEO, content, communities (slow, compounding)
- Paid: ads, sponsorships (fast, stops stops when money stops)
- Mixed: partnerships, events, PLG (test → scale)

Strategy:
- Test few channels
- Measure results
- Double down on 1–2 that work

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

cie

PES UNIVERSITY

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

cie

PES UNIVERSITY

CELEBRATING 50 YEARS

Essentials of Innovation & Entrepreneurship (EIE) - II

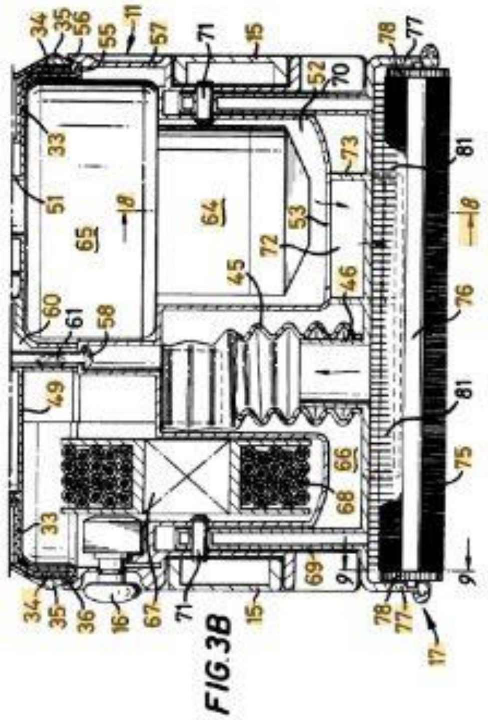
Module (M11): Role & Importance of Intellectual Property (IP) for Startups

The Secret Weapon of Startups: IP as a Growth Engine

Startups can create assets like patents, trademarks, and copyrights

Example: James Dyson's patented bagless vacuum cleaner to protect his invention from competitors and build a billion-dollar brand.

U.S. Patent Feb. 15, 1983 Sheet 3 of 8 4,373,228



Inventor: James Dyson

Current Assignee : Dyson Technology Ltd

Worldwide applications

1980 ~~US~~ ~~EP~~ ~~CA~~ JP 1981 ES

Application US06/140,497 events

1980-04-15	Application filed by Individual
1981-03-24	Priority to DE8181301255T
1983-02-15	Application granted
1983-02-15	Publication of US4373228A
2000-04-15	Anticipated expiration
Status	Expired - Lifetime

Winning with IP: Startups That Used It Smartly

Case Study 1: Tesla – The Open-Source Gamble

Tesla filed hundreds of patents in electric vehicle (EV) technology. In 2014, Elon Musk made a bold move—Tesla open-sourced its patents. Why? Encouraged industry-wide EV adoption while still keeping Tesla's brand and technology leadership intact. Lesson: IP isn't just about protection; it's also a strategic tool for market leadership.

Case Study 2: Netflix – Protecting Its Streaming Model

In the early 2000s, Netflix patented its subscription-based DVD rental system. This blocked competitors like Blockbuster from directly copying the model. Lesson: A well-placed patent can give a startup a head start and keep competitors at bay.

When Founders Ignore IP: Costly Mistakes

Case Study 3: Facebook vs. ConnectU – The Billion-Dollar Lesson

The Winklevoss twins created a social networking site, ConnectU, but did not protect their idea well. Mark Zuckerberg, who was hired to work on it, went on to create Facebook, which became a global phenomenon. Lawsuit settlement: $65 million, but Facebook went on to be worth hundreds of billions. Lesson: Execution matters more than just an idea; while ConnectU had the concept, Zuckerberg executed it in a way that turned Facebook into a global success

Case Study 4: The Tragic Fall of Theranos

Elizabeth Holmes promised breakthrough blood-testing technology. Theranos patented some of its technology but failed to make it functional. Investors didn't check whether the IP had real value, and the company collapsed. Lesson: Patents without execution and real innovation are useless.

Takeaway – Why Startups must care about IP

Patents → Give startups a monopoly on inventions, attracting investors

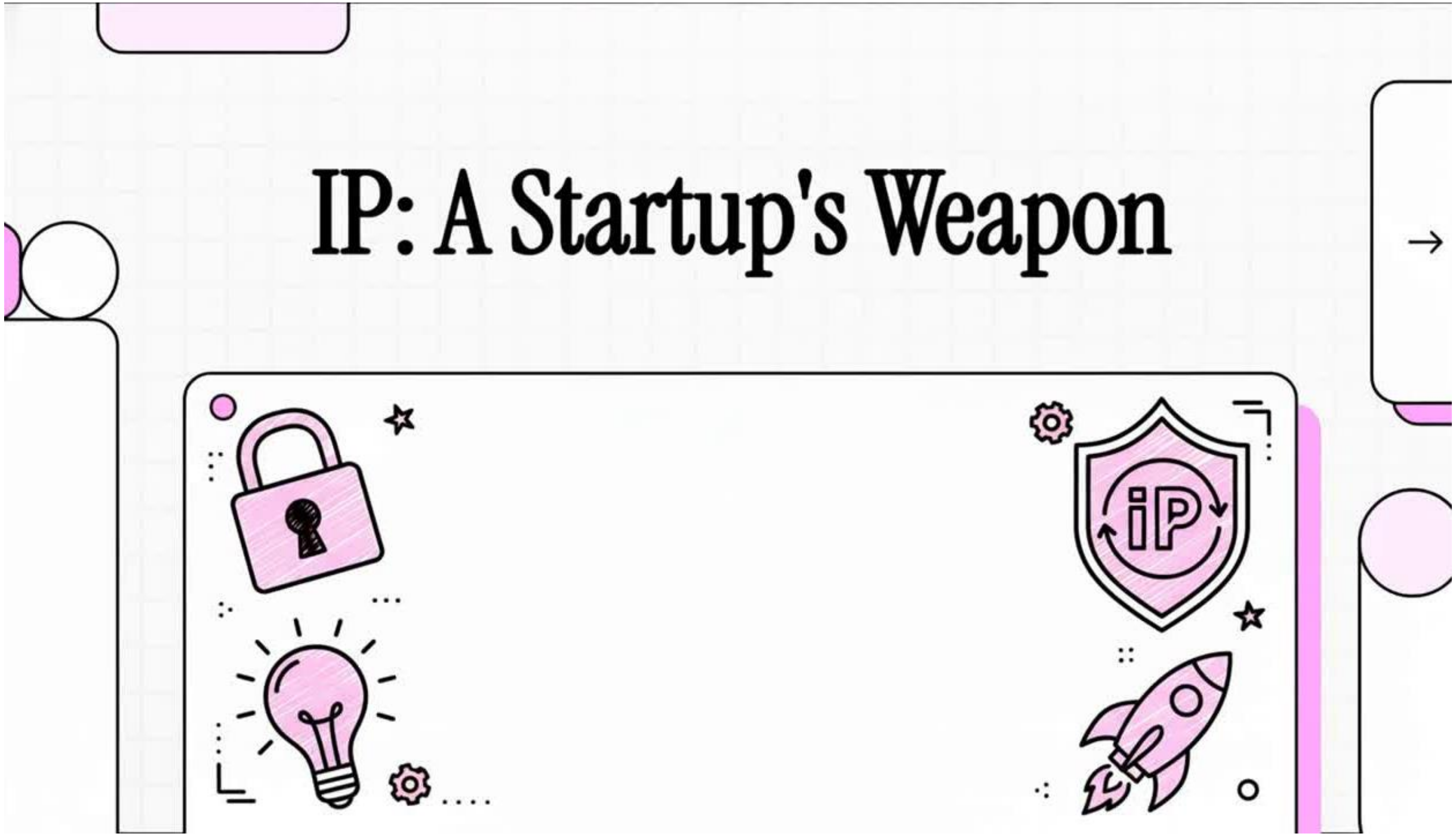
Trademarks → Create a strong brand identity (e.g., Nike’s swoosh)

Copyrights → Protect software, designs, and creative works

Trade Secrets → Keep business strategies confidential (e.g., Coca-Cola’s secret formula)

IP is an asset, not just a legal requirement.
The smart startups treat their IP as their most valuable weapon

IP: A Startup's Weapon



Expert Talk : Dr. Ravi Tumkur

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

PES UNIVERSITY

Expert Talk: Dr. Ravi Tumkur

- A techno-legal professional and a registered patent agent having 30 years of experience across IP, technology strategy and academia.

- Served as Senior Patent Counsel at Philips India and Versuni India Home Solutions Limited (Formerly known as Philips Domestic Appliances India Limited) for 23+ years.

- Prior to joining Philips, worked with IBM, GE, SAP Labs and in academia.

- Expertise in IP policy, patent portfolio creation, patent portfolio management and innovation enablement aligned with business goals.

Expert Talk :

Ms. Rumpi Ghosh – Assistant

Prof. of Law

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (cie)

PES UNIVERSITY

PESU CIE - EIE Journey

From Ideation to Entrepreneurial Action

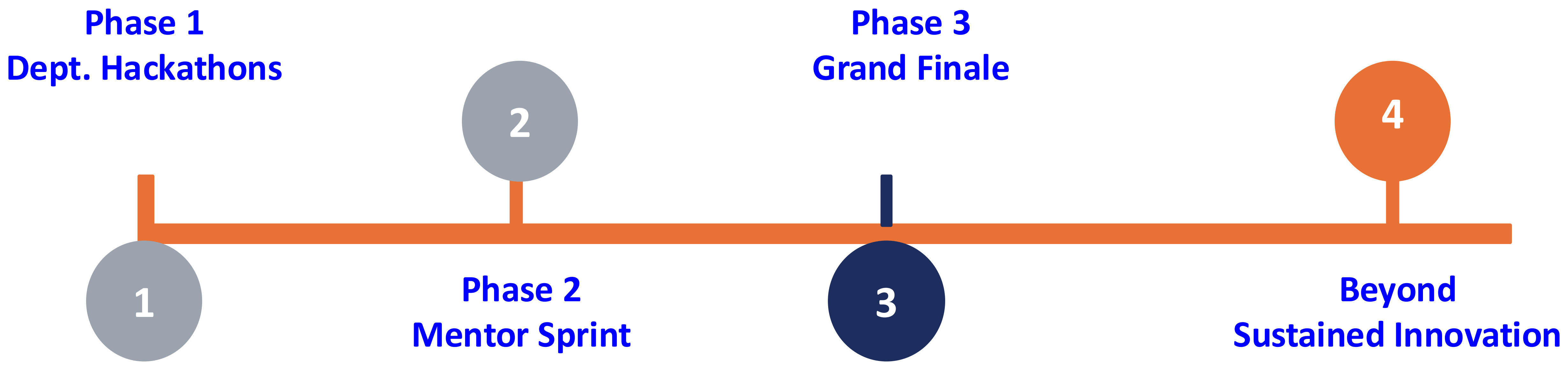
Module	EIE1 theme	EIE1	EIE2 theme	EIE2
M1		Intro to Innov. & Entre.		Startup Challenges
M2	Innovation Mindset	Entre. Mindset	Customer Discovery	Customer Discovery
M3	Design Thinking	Design Thinking		CD Deep-dive: Interviews
M4		Idea-to-Market Oppty & Ethics		CD Deep-dive: Hypotheses
M5	Teams & Leadership	Build & Lead Teams		CD Deep-dive: Best Practices
M6	Value Proposition	Value Proposition		Startup Finance Fund.
M7		Business Model Canvas & IP	Startup Marketing	Startup Marketing
M8	Pitching	Selling Idea & Pitching		Digital Business Models
M9		Startup Finance 1		Digital Marketing & AI Innov.
M10	Finance	Startup Finance 2		Startup Pitching II
M11	AI Innovation	AI Innovation	Legal	Startup Legal
M12		Entre. Action Plan		Entre. Action Plan

CIE Spark: Idea Validation Sprint

SPARK
by CIE

The CIE Ignite Journey

A three-phase innovation pipeline



IGNITE
By CIE

CENTRE FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Bird's-eye View of EIE I & II

PES UNIVERSITY

EIE-1: Discovery

Entrepreneurship Fundamentals, Entrepreneurial Mindset, Creativity–Innovation–Imagination, Opportunity Identification, Design Thinking, Idea to Market Process, Team Building, Value Proposition, Business Model Canvas, Pitching & Selling, Startup Finance, AI in Innovation

VALUE CREATION

EIE-2: Execution

Startup Failure Analysis, Lean Startup Principles, Customer Development, Business Model Canvas, MVP & Iteration, Market Validation, Jobs-To-Be-Done (JTBD), Marketing & Market Structure, Startup Finance (Advanced), Intellectual Property (IP), Pitching & Execution, Startup Scaling & Strategy

Foundation

Growth Mindset and Entrepreneurial Thinking as the starting point.

Core

Human-centered design and architecting the Business Model (BMC).

Engine

Advanced Finance and the Funding Ladder to fuel market expansion.

Accelerator

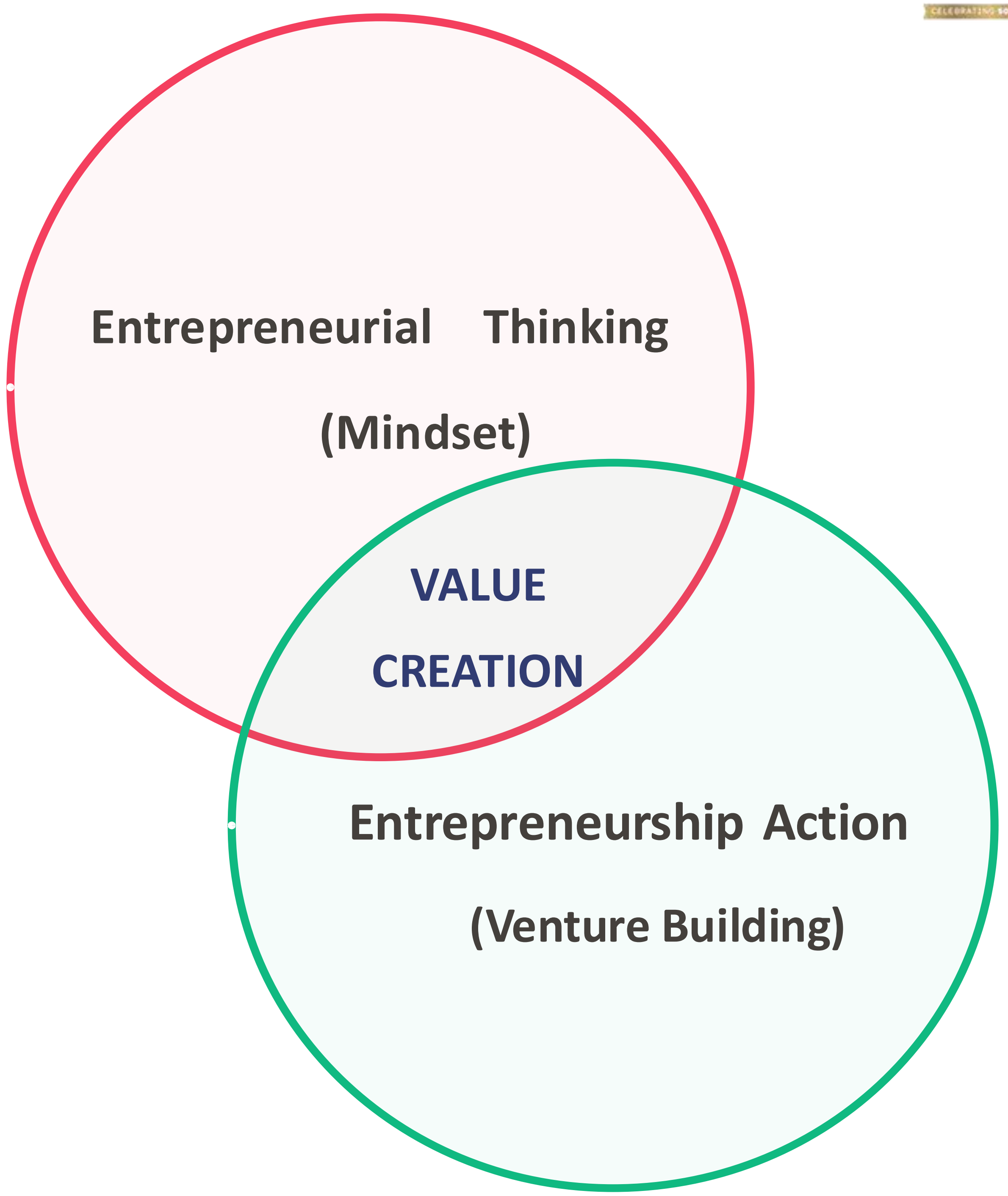
AI-driven speed and the personal Entrepreneurial Action Plan.

Note: this is a representative view & not a complete summary of EIE1 and EIE2. See CIE website for details

Mindset: The Foundation of Innovation

Entrepreneurship is a choice of action,

while "Entrepreneurial" is a way of thinking applicable to any role.



- **Growth Mindset:** Abilities are developed through effort, not static traits.
- **Intrapreneurship:** Driving bold change and taking risks within existing organizations.
- **Initiative:** Acting on opportunities to create financial, cultural, or social value.
- **Calculated Risk-taking:** Pursuing high-impact opportunities by carefully balancing uncertainty against potential rewards.

Opportunity: Filtering Ideas → Ventures

Not every idea is an opportunity; high-potential ventures must pass the TIPSC filter to ensure viability.

- **TIPSC Framework:** Timely, Important, Profitable, Solvable, and Context-aligned.
- **Problem-First:** Focusing on "Good & Real" problems rather than just trending solutions.
- **NABC (Need):** Identifying a specific client need as the first pillar of the SRI framework.
- **Ethics & Integrity:** Balancing profit with transparency and sustainability.

> **TIPSC Filter:** Acts as a quality gate that prevents wasting resources on ideas that lack market fit or ethical grounding.

RAW IDEAS

TIPSC FILTER | NABC (NEED) | ETHICS CHECK

VALIDATED OPPORTUNITY

Human-Centered Innovation: The Design Loop

Innovation starts with empathy, not technology; it is an iterative loop of understanding, building, and testing.

Empathize
Deeply understanding user pains and needs.

Define
Framing the core problem to solve.

Ideate
Generating diverse, creative solutions.

Prototype
Building low-fidelity versions to learn.

Test
Validating assumptions with real users.

ITERATIVE FEEDBACK LOOP

Value Proposition: Solving the Customer’s "Job"

Value is created when a product’s gains and pain-relievers perfectly align with the customer’s jobs and pains.

Value Map

Gain Creators: How you create positive outcomes.

Pain Relievers: How you eliminate hurdles.

Products & Services: The core offering.

PROBLEM-SOLUTION FIT

Customer Profile

Customer Jobs: Tasks they try to perform.

Pains: Risks and obstacles faced.

Gains: Benefits they desire.

The BMC: Architecting the Business

A business model is a system of 9 interconnected blocks that describe how an organization creates, delivers, and captures value.

Key Partners
Network of suppliers and partners.

Key Activities
Most important things to do.

Key Resources
Assets required to offer value.

Value Proposition
The Bridge: Products and services that create value.

Customer Relationships
Types of links with segments.

Channels
How you reach customers.

Customer Segments
The people or orgs you serve.

Cost Structure
All costs incurred to operate the business model.

Revenue Streams
Cash generated from each customer segment.

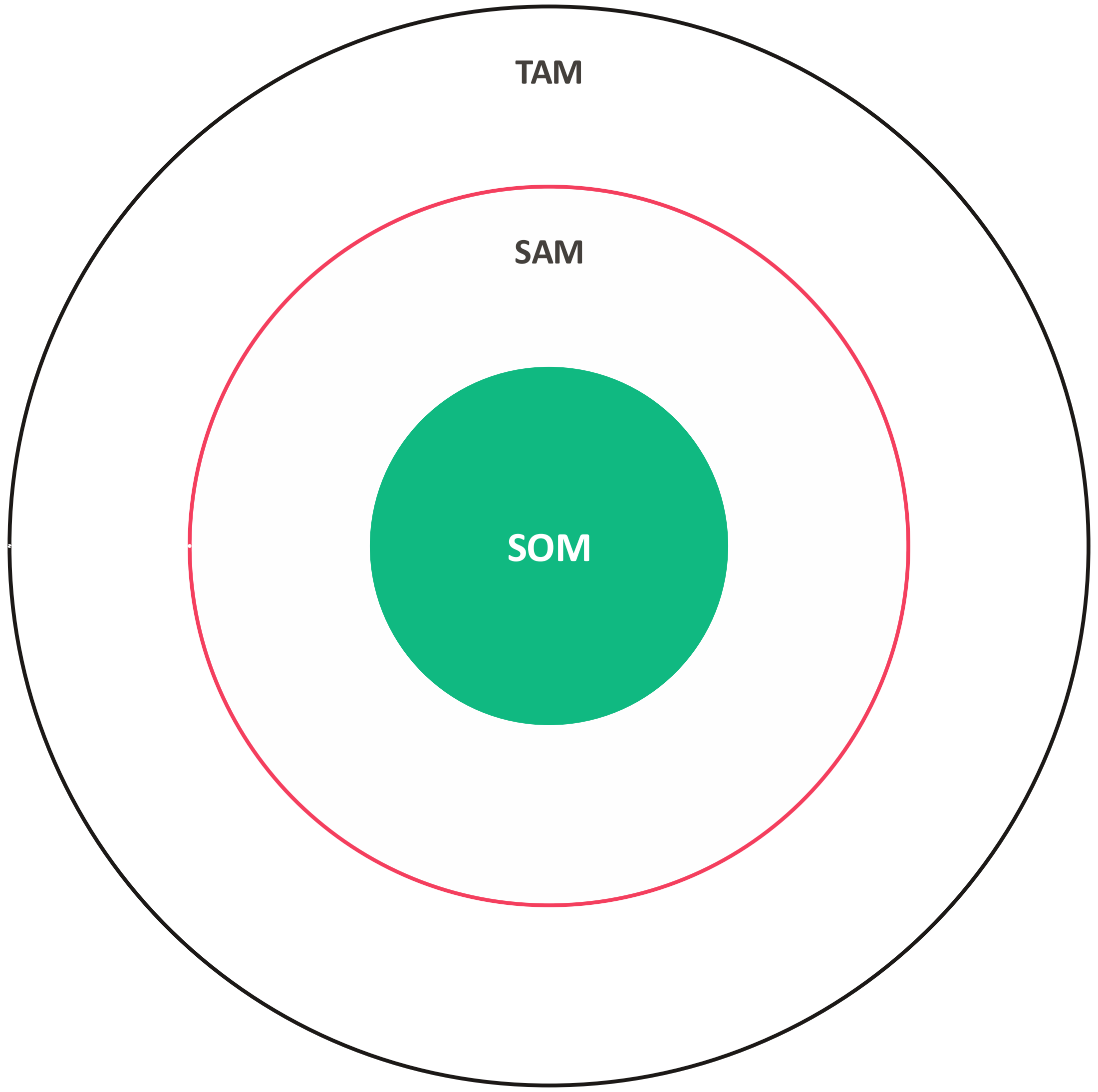
Back Stage (Efficiency)
Infrastructure & Operations

The Bridge (Value)
The Core Offering

Front Stage (Value)
Market & Customer Experience

Market & Finance: The Math of Viability

Profitability depends on capturing a realistic slice (SOM) of a large market (TAM) while managing survival cash flow.



TAM: Total Addressable Market (Global Opportunity)

SAM: Serviceable Addressable Market (Your Reach)

SOM: Serviceable Obtainable Market (Realistic Capture)

Bootstrapping

Using personal savings and early revenue to maintain control and agility without external debt.

Financial Statements

Tracking the Income Statement (Profit) and Cash Flow (Survival) to ensure the engine keeps running.

SAFE Notes

Simple Agreements for Future Equity—a flexible tool for early-stage funding without immediate valuation.

Gross Profit & Margins

Ensuring every unit sold contributes enough to cover fixed costs and drive long-term growth.

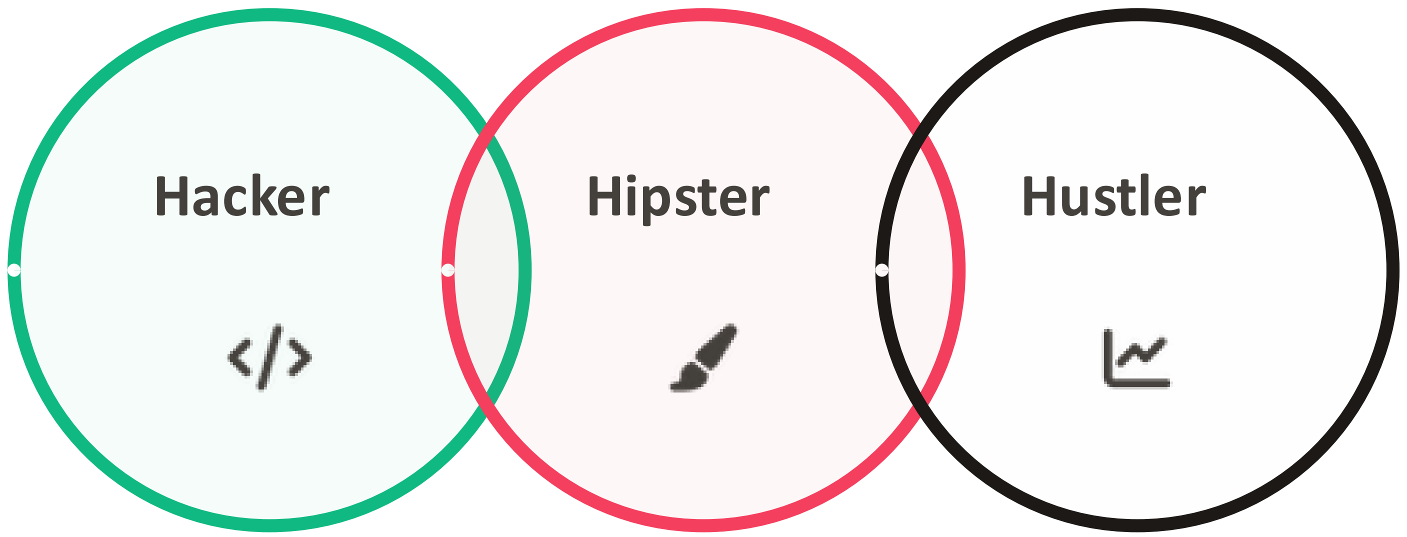
Execution:

Building Teams & Selling the Vision

Entrepreneurship is a team sport; success requires a mix of skills and the ability to pitch the "Why."

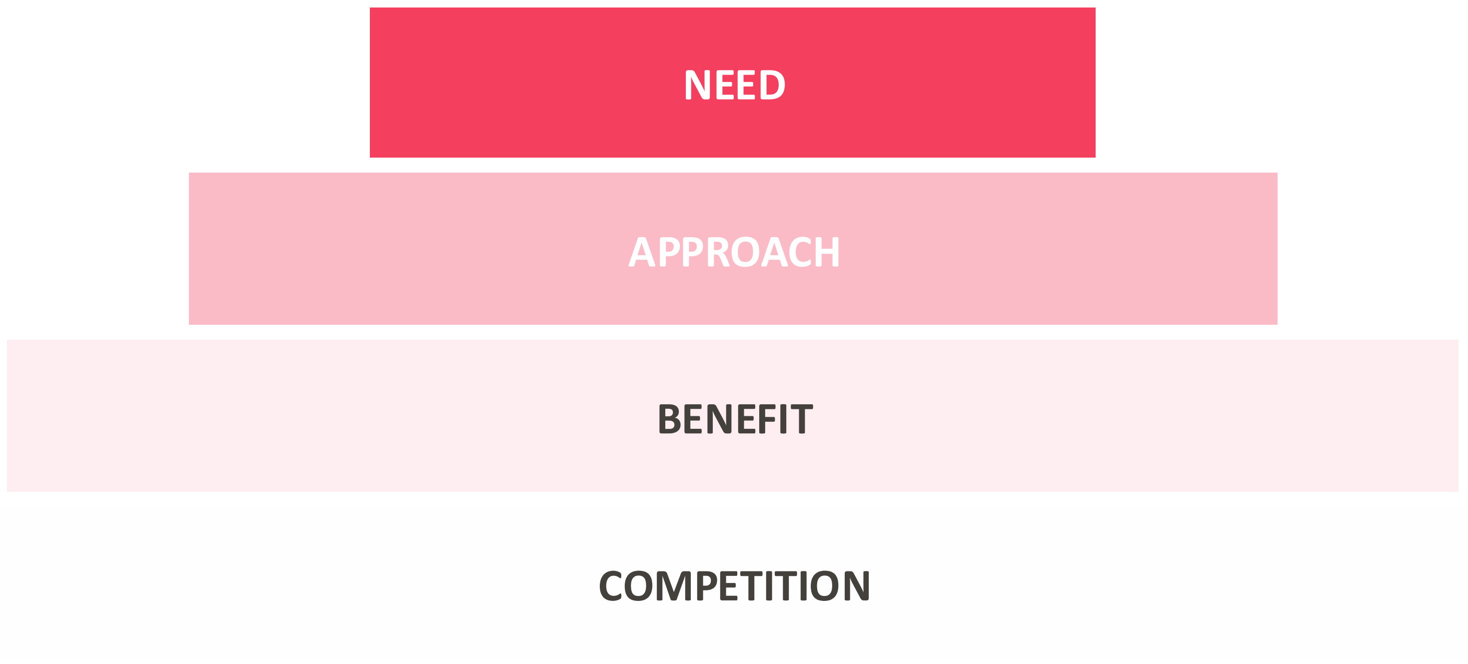
The 3H Team Model

- **Hacker:** The technical engine building the product.
- **Hipster:** The design soul ensuring user experience.
- **Hustler:** The business mind driving sales and growth.
- **Leadership:** Moving from individual detective to collaborator.



The NABC Pitch

- **Need:** Start with the validated customer pain point.
- **Approach:** Your unique solution and business model.
- **Benefit:** The specific value and gains for the user.
- **Competition:** Why you are better than alternatives.



The Startup Lifecycle: Managing Growth

The Funding Ladder: Fueling Growth

Funding is not a one-time event but a ladder where each rung matches a specific stage of maturity and risk.

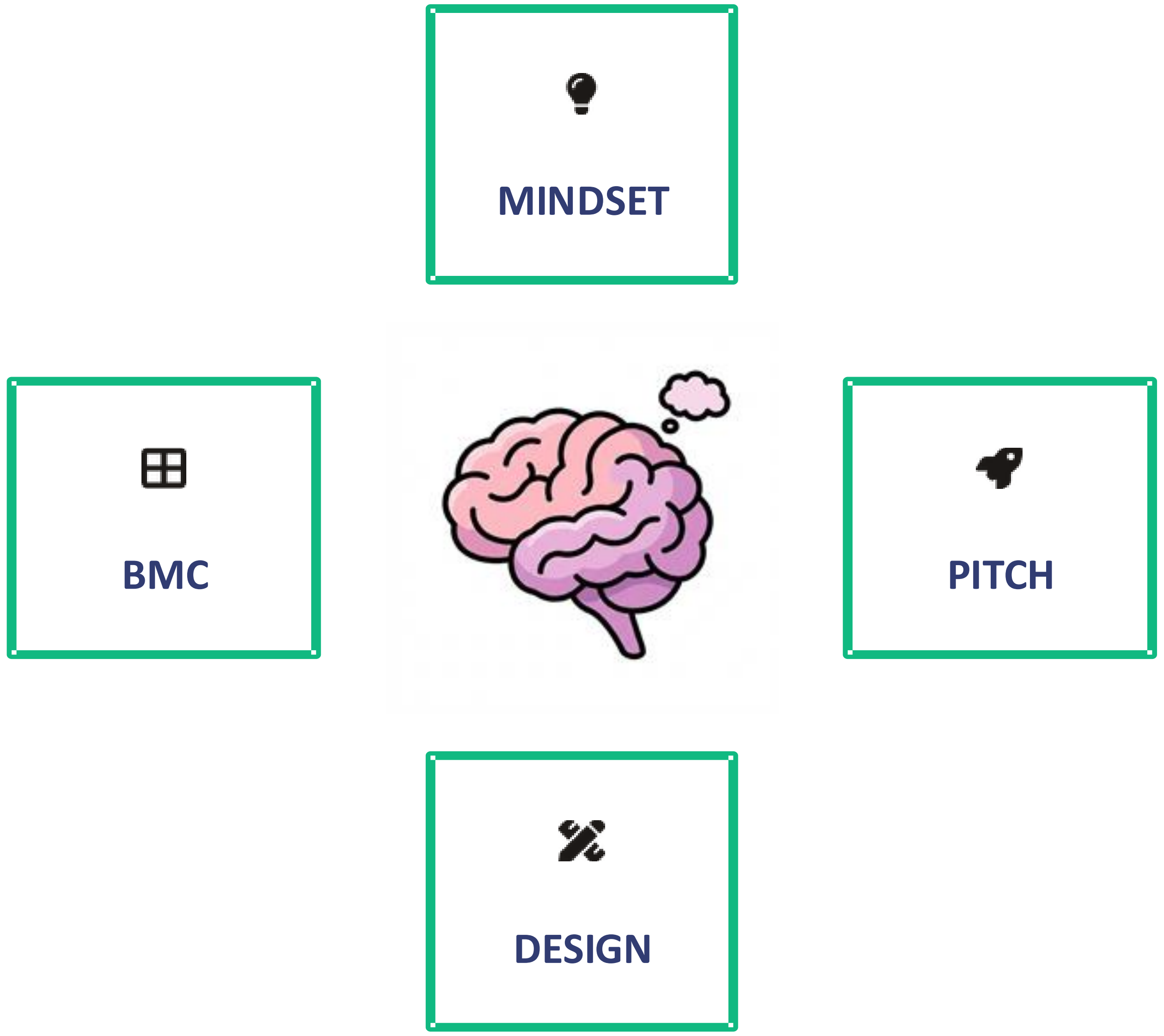
- Bootstrapping: Using personal savings for control and agility.
- Angel Investors: Early equity or convertible debt from individuals.
- Venture Capital: Professional firms for high-growth potential.
- SAFE Notes: Fast, flexible tool without immediate valuation.

AI: Reimagining the Innovation Cycle

AI is not just a tool but a collaborator that accelerates every stage of the Idea-to-Market journey.

- **GenAI in Ideation:** Rapidly generating and refining concepts to shorten the design loop.
- **Operational Automation:** Reducing "Back Stage" costs and increasing efficiency in the BMC.
- **Predictive Analytics:** Understanding customer needs and market trends before they arise.
- **Ethics in AI:** Ensuring transparency, privacy, and accountability in automation.

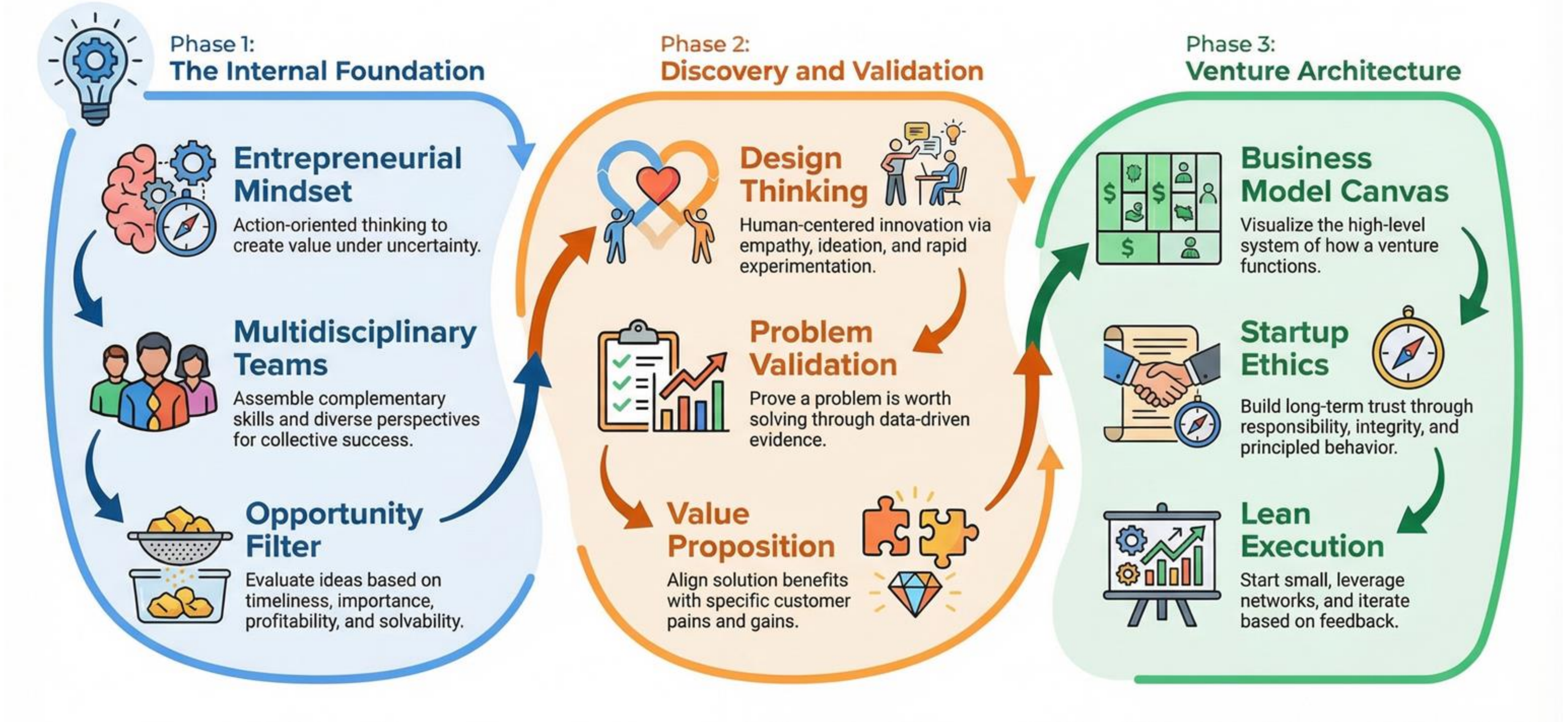
> **Final Step:** Leverage AI to move from theoretical learning to your personal **Entrepreneurial Action Plan**.



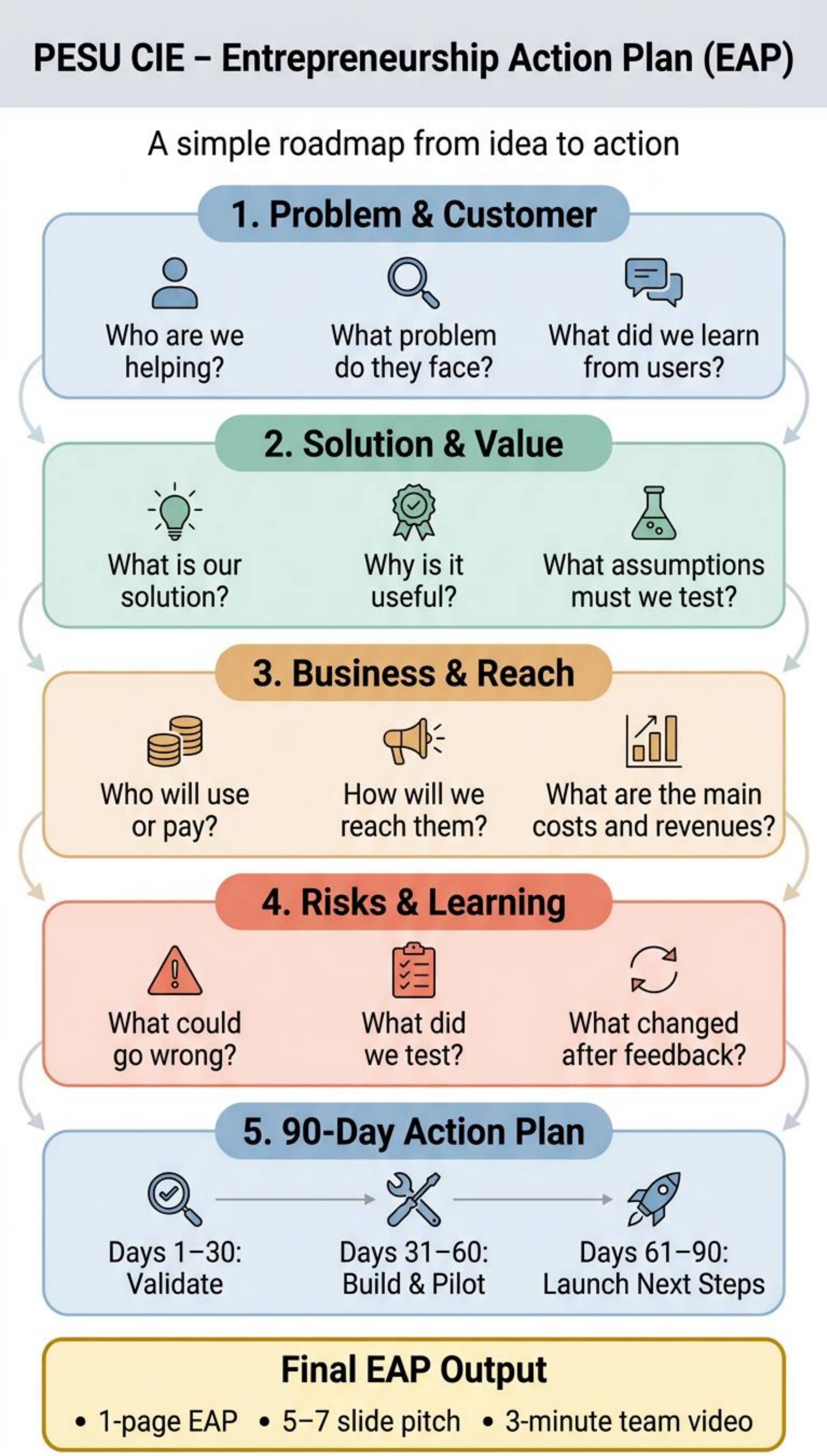
Ethics: Innovating with Responsibility

- **Transparency:** Clearly explaining how AI decisions are made to build user trust.
- **Privacy & Consent:** Ensuring responsible collection and use of personal data.
- **Accountability:** Taking ownership of AI-driven outcomes and avoiding shortcuts.
- **AI Literacy:** Building skills to thrive in a human-AI combined workplace.

The EIE Journey



Entrepreneurship Action Plan



Entrepreneurship Action Plan (EAP)

Turning an idea into a real action roadmap

- An **Entrepreneurship Action Plan (EAP)** is a short, practical summary of a team's startup idea, customer understanding, validation, and next steps.

- It helps you - students move beyond "just an idea" and show what problem they are solving, for whom, and what evidence they have gathered.

- In EIE, the EAP should be simple, realistic, and based on customer discovery, testing, and learning.

- **Problem & Customer:** Who are we helping, and what pain point are we solving?

- **Solution & Value:** What is our solution, and why is it useful or different?

- **Validation:** What did users say, what did we test, and what did we learn?

- **Business & Reach:** Who will use or pay, and how will we reach them?

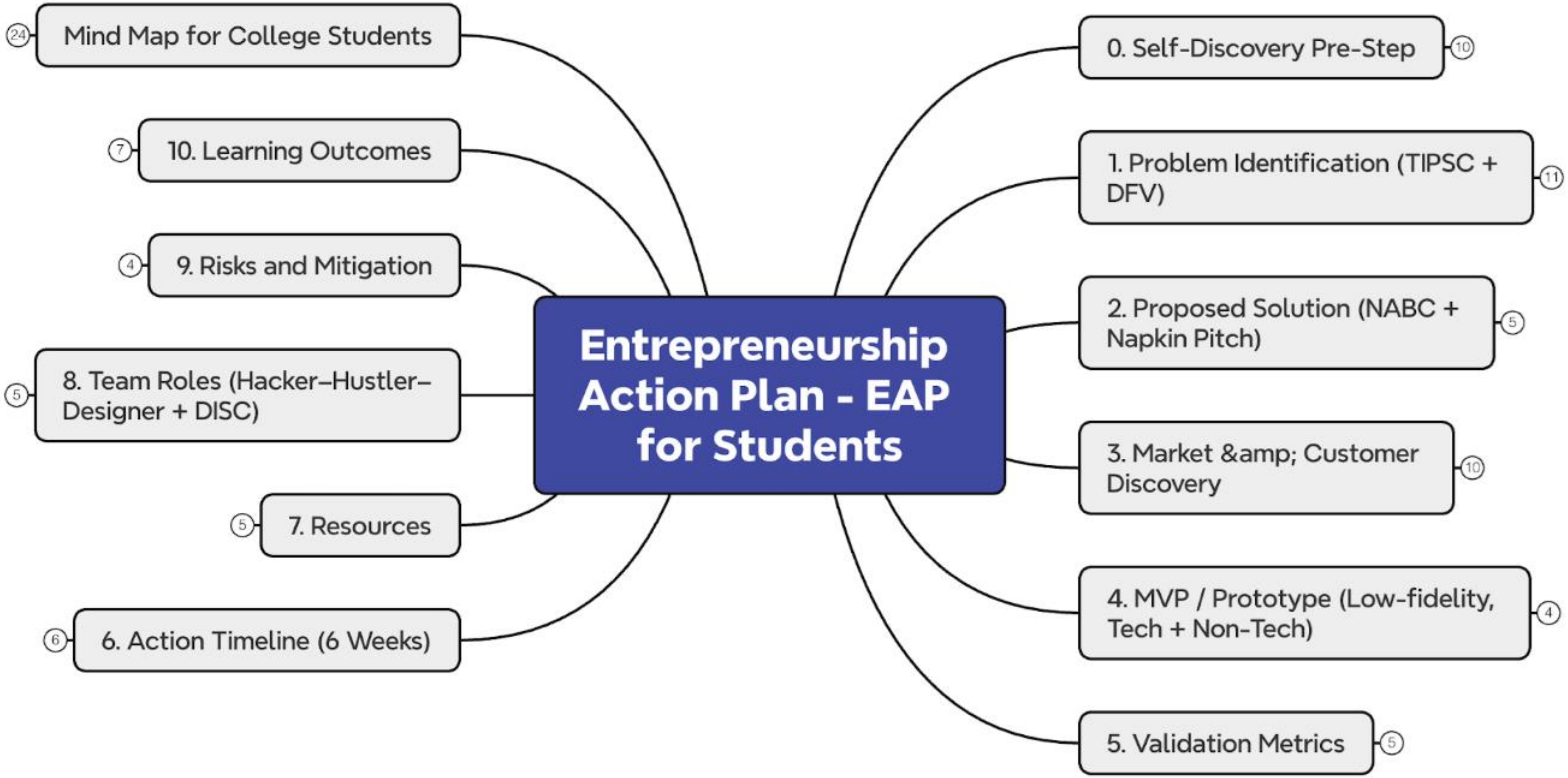
- **90-Day Plan:** What will we validate, build, pilot, and improve in the next three months?

EAP - Structure

From classroom idea to action-ready startup concept

- ✓ **1-page EAP:** A concise summary of problem, customer, solution, validation, business model, and roadmap.
- ✓ **5–7 slide pitch:** A short presentation explaining the opportunity, evidence, and next steps.
- ✓ **3-minute team video:** A simple verbal pitch that shows clarity, confidence, and teamwork.
- ✓ The goal is not perfection; the goal is to show **evidence of learning, iteration, and action**.

Entrepreneurship Action Plan – Mind Map



Key aspects to remember…

- **Stay curious, not certain.** Keep asking "why, what if, why not?" in every course, project, and internship; curiosity is one of the strongest predictors of entrepreneurial alertness and opportunity recognition.

- **Treat problems as invitations.** When you see an inefficiency on campus, in society, or in industry, train yourself to see it as a design brief, not a complaint; entrepreneurs are solutions-oriented even when conditions look tough.

- **Practice small, safe experiments.** Instead of waiting for a "perfect" startup idea, run tiny tests—talk to users, prototype in a weekend, pilot with a club—because entrepreneurial learning comes from repeated action and feedback, not just planning.

- **Build resilience, not perfection.** Use every failure (rejected idea, low turnout, bug, exam slip-up) as data to iterate your approach; resilience, adaptability, and optimism in the face of setbacks are core entrepreneurial traits that can be developed over time.

- **Grow your opportunity network.** Surround yourself with peers, mentors, and communities that like building things—clubs, hackathons, CIE events, incubators—since entrepreneurial mindset and confidence grow faster when students work collaboratively on real challenges.